

Book 1

*RHYTHM
STYLE*



Part 1

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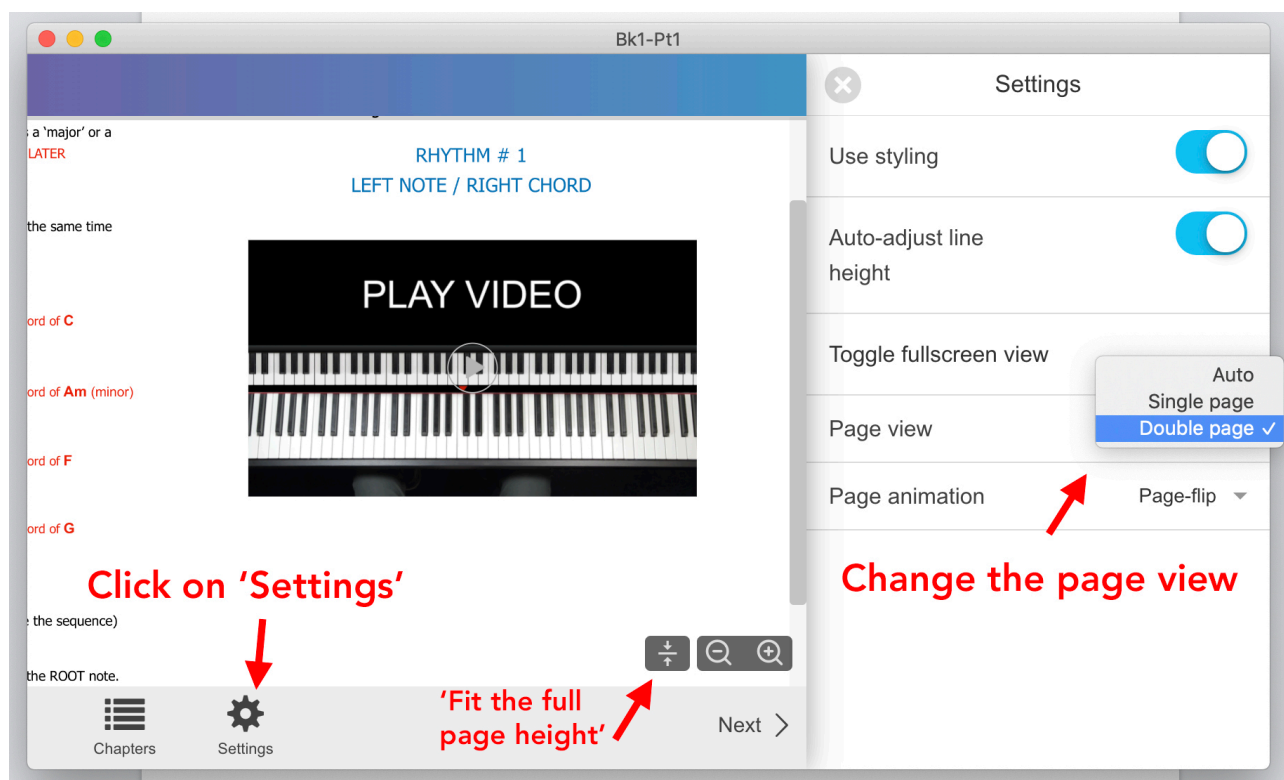


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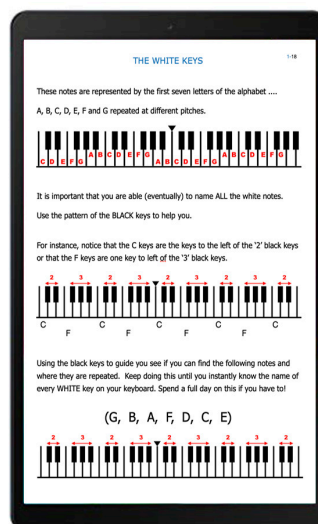
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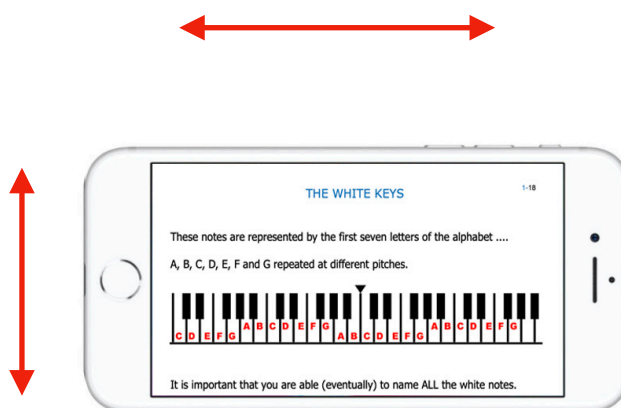
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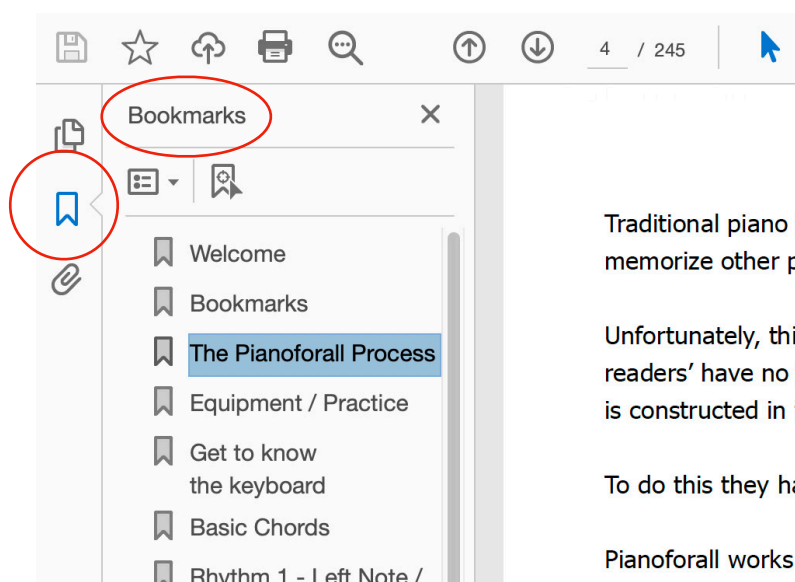
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You can click on **BOOKMARKS** which will bring up a clickable Table Of Contents



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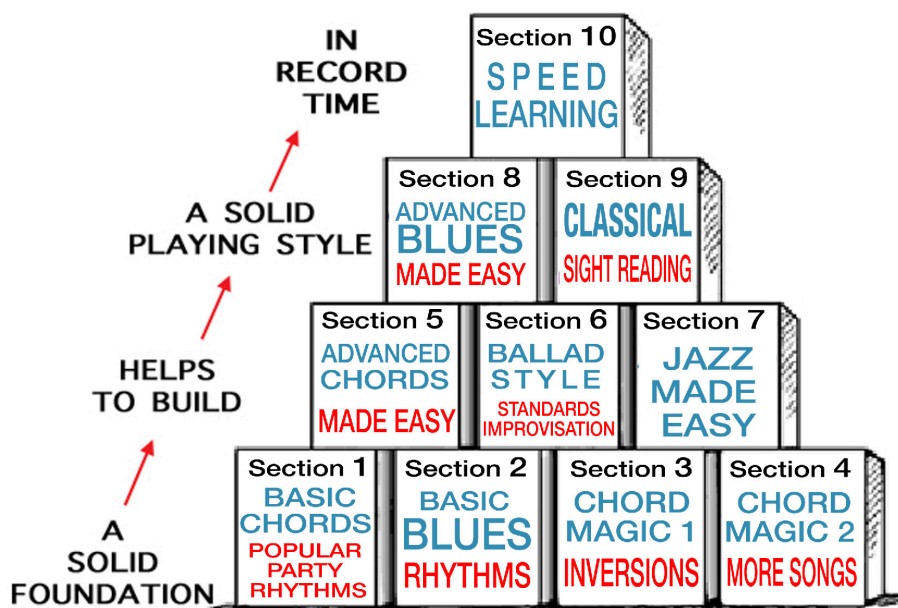
Pianoforall works t

Traditional piano instruction generally begins with Sight Reading (being taught to memorize other peoples musical compositions using musical notation)

Unfortunately, this is an extremely laborious process and many accomplished 'sight readers' have no idea about how to play by ear or how the music they can sight read is constructed in the first place.

To do this they have to learn about chords and harmony.

Pianoforall works the other way round. You build a solid foundation using chords, 'real' sounding rhythms and grooves and then you BUILD on top of that and learn to play by ear and sight read along the way.



SECTIONS 1 TO 5 - LAY THE FOUNDATION

The secret to learning piano in the shortest time possible is to start with CHORDS. Even if you don't like to 'sing-a-long' with chords or you already have some knowledge of chords I still urge you to work through sections 1 to 5. There are some TERRIFIC party rhythms and the knowledge you gain will be invaluable. Pianoforall uses lots of memory tricks and formulas to speed up the learning process.

SECTIONS 6 to 10 - BUILD ON THAT FOUNDATION

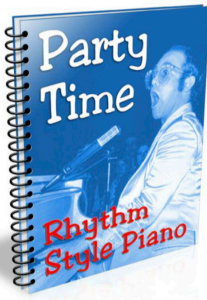
With the foundation laid the sky is the limit. Ballads, Jazz, Blues, Ragtime, Improvisation, composing melodies, Classical sight reading ALL become SO much easier when you have a solid foundation in chords, rhythm and basic harmony.

RHYTHM STYLE PIANO

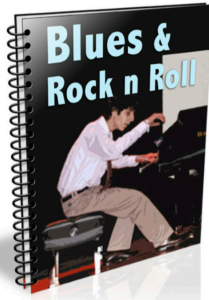
COMPLETE UNDERSTANDING OF CHORDS & RHYTHMS

Chords in the right hand with left hand notes or patterns

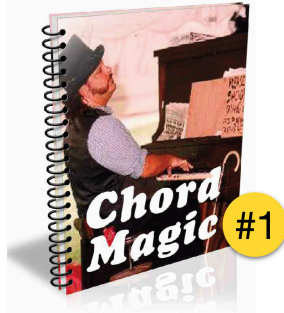
SECTION 1



SECTION 2



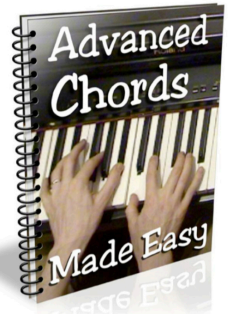
SECTION 3



SECTION 4



SECTION 5



LEADS TO PLAYING MELODY & IMPROVISATION

Chords in the LEFT HAND with Right Hand Melody and Chord Tones

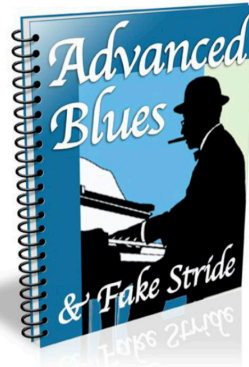
SECTION 6



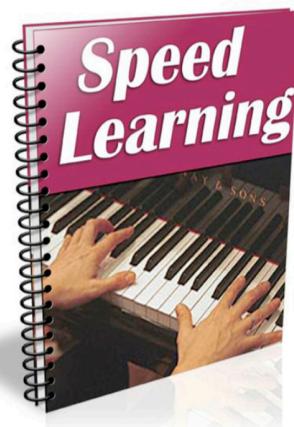
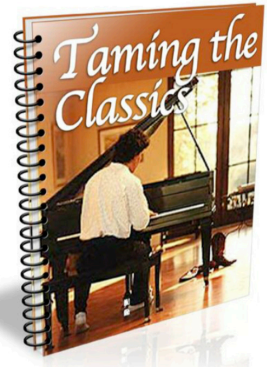
SECTION 7



SECTION 8



SECTION 9



SECTION 10
Scales
Arpeggios
Exercises
and workout in
ALL keys

Sections 1 to 5 teach 'Rhythm Style' piano - the same way people learn rhythm guitar. They learn chords - then they learn how to 'strum' a rhythm and then they sing along over the top.



You start with rhythm style piano because you can sound reasonably competent right away and you learn all about chords and how to use both hands together



Most popular singer-pianists like Billy Joel or Elton John play rhythm style piano - they don't play the melody because they are singing it.

If you listen to a song like 'Imagine' you will hear that the piano is rhythm style because you don't want to play the melody and sing at the same time

So remember - that you won't be playing the MELODY of these songs (in sections 1 to 5) so you won't be listening for that - you are trying to emulate the background rhythm. Because of copyright I can't show you all the exact extra riffs and so on but I try to give you as close a sound as possible

From section 6 onwards you will be applying your chord and rhythm knowledge to MELODIES - Ballad style - Jazz - Blues - Improvisation and even Classical pieces.

An understanding of CHORDS and RHYTHMS is ESSENTIAL for all these different genres. Chords are the BUILDING BLOCKS of ALL music

I assure you, you will be amazed at where this will all take you - but you need to put your preconceptions about what way you THINK you should be learning aside and please try to trust the lessons

Best of luck :-)



You have to learn to walk
before you can run..

The rhythms you are about to learn
are REAL rhythms

But because this is section 1 they are in their most BASIC form so that
complete beginners can play them.

As you progress you will learn how to embellish these rhythms with extra
little touches that will make them far more 'musical'

As your 'ear' develops you will also be able to
add melody lines TO these rhythms.

But - you have to start somewhere.

Your mission in section 1 is to make even these
BASIC chords and rhythms sing and swing!

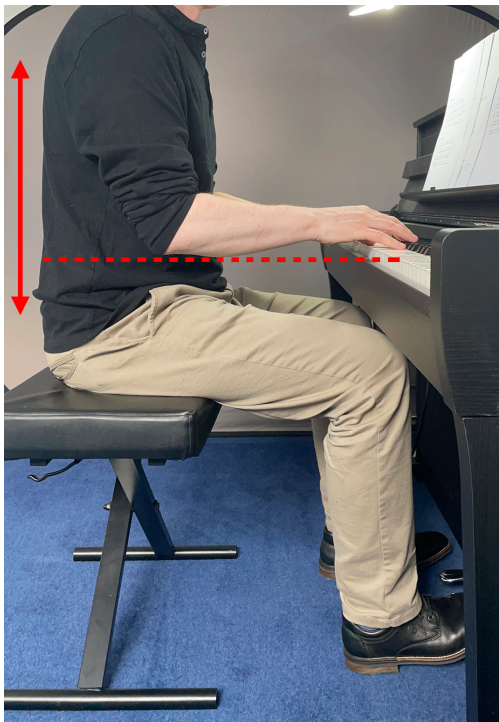
If a rhythm sounds bland - figure out how to spice it up -
alter the beat slightly - vary the loudness -
put more of an accent on certain beats -
add in your own touches if you can - experiment.

But above all - make SURE you know these chords
and rhythms BEFORE you move on.

The Rhythms in this section are the basic underlying rhythms used in
nearly EVERY popular tune ever written.

FIRST THINGS FIRST

KEYBOARDS



STOOL



PEDAL

POSTURE

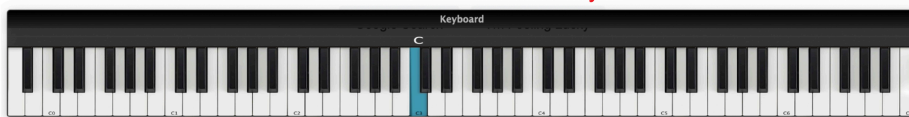
WHAT KIND OF KEYBOARD

If you have yet to purchase a keyboard please keep the following criteria in mind.



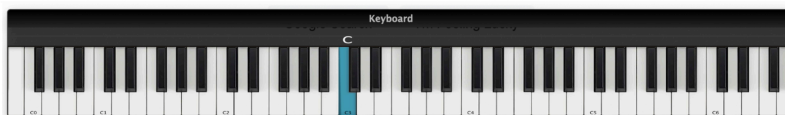
It should have **at least 61 keys** - more is preferable. The keys should be full piano size keys - definitely NOT a mini keyboard.

88 Full Size Piano Keys



You don't really need 88 keys

76 Keys keyboard



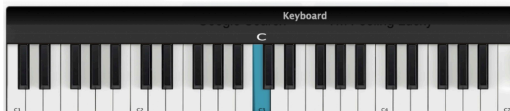
76 is a good number

61 Keys keyboard



61 keys are ok but you will eventually miss not being able to play lower

49 Keys keyboard



49 keys are simply not enough to learn on

I prefer weighted or semi weighted keys - but its up to your budget.

It ABSOLUTELY MUST have 'Touch Response' or 'Touch Sensitivity'

'Touch Response' means that the keys will respond to how hard or how lightly you strike them which will give your playing far more expression. If a keyboard doesn't have touch response every note will have exactly the same loudness ALL the time which will make your playing sound infuriatingly robotic.

A SUSTAIN PEDAL IS ESSENTIAL!

You also **MUST** have a **sustain pedal** - if your keyboard can't take a pedal then get a new keyboard. Check the back of the keyboard for a pedal INPUT.



A sustain pedal enables you to make a note continue sounding even after you lift your finger off the key.

Without a sustain pedal each note will last for only the length of time you have your finger on the key - so once you lift your finger the note stops sounding - very abruptly. So you can imagine - EVERYTHING without a pedal sounds 'staccato' - like clockwork - there is no variety - no 'sustain' - no depth.

I recommend the piano style sustain pedal rather than the tiny square black plastic pedal that forever moves around under your feet - and unless you are wanting to be a concert pianist - all you will need is a single sustain pedal.

Make sure you get a sustain pedal that is compatible with your keyboard brand and remember when you use a sustain pedal for the first time DON'T put your foot on it when you switch the piano on or else it will work in reverse - if you do that by mistake just switch off again - take your foot off the pedal and switch the keyboard on again.

WHAT ABOUT THE SUSTAIN SETTING ON YOUR KEYBOARD?

Many students ask if the sustain setting on their keyboard will do instead of a pedal.

The problem with the sustain setting is it creates CONTINUOUS sustain which is as bad as no sustain at all - everything you play becomes one continuous mess - like how an orchestra sounds when they are all tuning up their instruments .

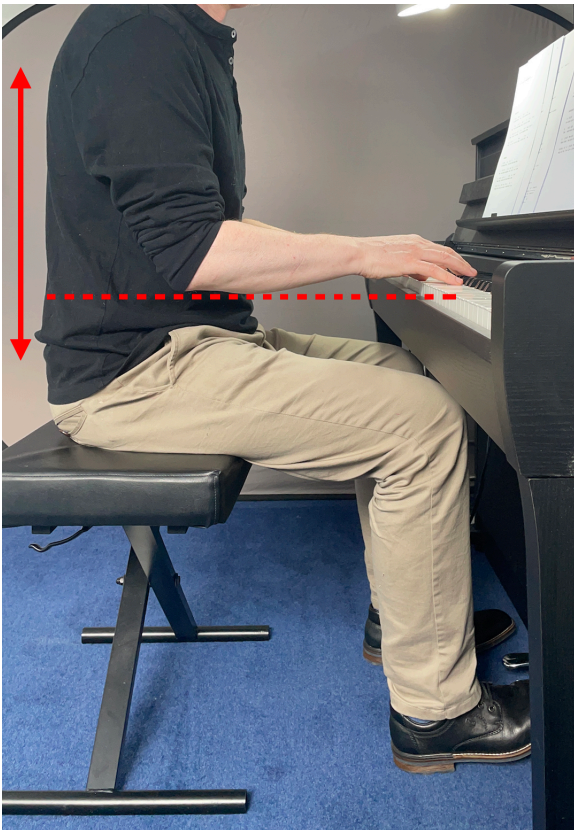


WHAT HEIGHT FOR YOUR KEYBOARD

Keyboards generally come with an adjustable stand. On an average acoustic Piano the height from the floor to the top of the keys is between 28 and 29 inches (71 and 74 cms). So aim for that height then adjust your piano stool.

PIANO STOOL

The first thing I would suggest is that you get a VERY comfortable chair or piano stool because sitting for even half an hour at the piano can make you quite sore to begin with. Personally I like the piano stools with the very large and thick padded seat - and one that can be adjusted to ANY height.

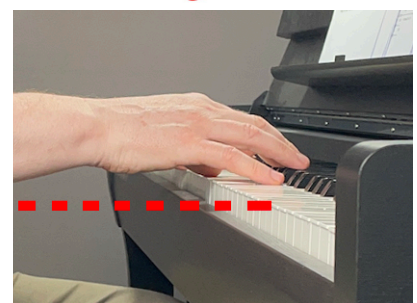
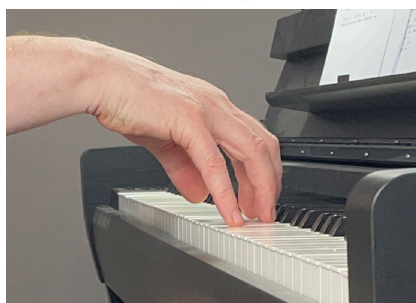


POSTURE

The height is important because you want to sit so that when your back is straight your lower arms (from your elbows to your wrists) are parallel to the ground and very slightly above the keys. You should sit close enough to the piano so that you can keep your back straight and relaxed. Your feet should be flat on the floor. It is also important to wear flexible shoes for when you use the pedal.

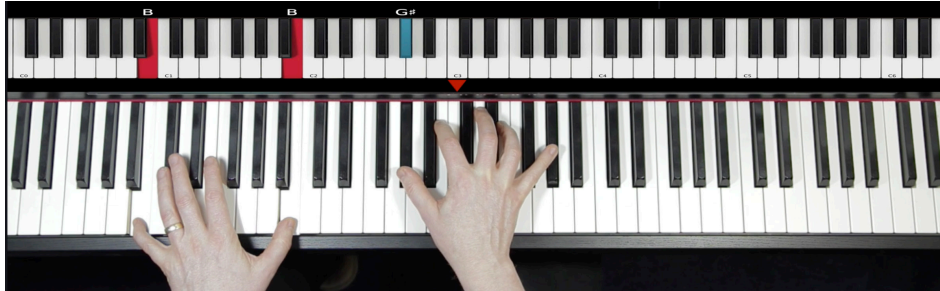
HAND POSITION

Keep the palm of your hands parallel to the ground. Try not to bend your wrists too much.



ADJUST YOUR POSITION IF NECESSARY

When you play a piece try to get a sense of being generally in the middle of the movement of the hands over the entire piece - so if it's a song that is nearly all played below middle C it's fine to shift yourself on the seat slightly to the left to make it all easier to play.



SET UP A GOOD LIGHT

Apart from needing to see the keys properly, you will be printing many of the pages of the course to set on your keyboard so it is important that you have a good light to be able to read them without getting eye strain.



STAY RELAXED

To begin with, learning piano can make you feel quite strained - you are using muscles that you have never used before.

Don't play too long. Take lots of breaks - even at the piano stop your practice now and then and gently stretch your arms and shoulders.

Keep your shoulders relaxed as you play. When we concentrate we tend to hold our breath so just relax your stomach now and then and you will breathe naturally.

HOW MUCH PRACTICE TIME

Like any training that involves muscles it is best to build up very slowly. No more than 20 minutes a day for a week or two building up to an hour or two.



It is best to divide your practice into two halves - in the first half practice any new exercises that are challenging. In the second half 'reward' yourself with the easier exercises or something you learned that is fun. You want to leave every practice session feeling positive. If you play the easy stuff first you may get tired and neglect the more challenging exercises, which slows down your progress.



HOW TO PRACTICE

Keep one thing in mind overall - the quickest way to improve on any difficult areas is DAILY - REPETITIVE practice.

If you find any exercise or technique difficult, just isolate it down to one or two bars or chords and repeat hundreds of times over a few days or weeks. When you do that you progress rapidly.

MUSCLE MEMORY

Many beginners repeat a few dozen times and wonder why they aren't improving. Professional musicians repeat hundreds or thousands of times to build **muscle memory**.

It's like learning to juggle - don't worry about mistakes just try again and again - build the muscle memory - relax and repeat - DAILY!



HOW LONG TO STAY ON EACH EXERCISE, CHAPTER OR SECTION

When you watch a video, treat it as if you have just had a face to face private lesson and that you are expected to **PRACTICE** what you learned **BETWEEN** lessons.

Of course **YOU** have to decide how long you need to practice and I know that's not easy.

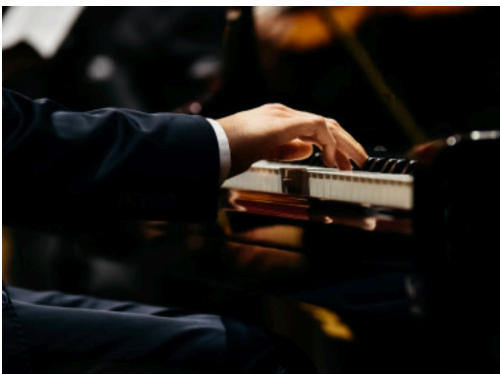
If you are able to play an exercise reasonably well, it's ok to move on, but you need to be sure you understand the concepts, whether it's a new rhythm or a new chord etc.



It doesn't have to be 'perfect' - in fact it may take a long time to perfect certain techniques but you just add them into your practice as you move on.

For instance the Blues Rhythms in section 2 can be easy to understand and are not too difficult to play slowly, but it may take months or even years to become totally proficient in them - so you can just add them into your practice now and then and over time they become easier.

REPETITION IS THE KEY TO SUCCESS



If you are really struggling with a lesson stick with it for a while and just keep repeating it over and over for a few days. I can't emphasize enough the importance of **REPETITION**.

Professional pianists may repeat a single passage thousands of times so that it becomes automatic.

Every now and then just go back to the start of whatever section you have been working on and play every exercise again. If you struggle with anything, flag it up as something to work on and add it to your daily practice.

APPLY WHAT YOU LEARN TO AS MANY COMPLETE SONGS AS YOU CAN

The exercises will teach you a lot - but the **REAL** learning will go in when you use the exercises to help you play **FULL** songs. You will learn how to do that later on in this section.

ARE WE THERE YET? - ARE WE THERE YET?

So many students ask HOW LONG WILL IT TAKE to complete the course? - or to become proficient enough to play ANY song just by hearing it?

I'm afraid those are IMPOSSIBLE questions to answer definitively - Sorry :(

Everyone learns at a different speed - everyone has different levels of ability - some people have a bit of skill on the piano - some people have more time to practice - some are more motivated - some want to be professional pianists and some just want to play a few songs for friends or family.

The variables are ENDLESS!

Just try to accept that it will take as long as it takes. If you want to make any real progress you need to devote at LEAST an hour a day to practice - and you need to practice **EVERY DAY!!**

Some students complete section 1 in weeks.
Some complete it in MONTHS.
and some take a YEAR or more!
and ALL of that is perfectly fine!



THE GOLDEN RULE OF PRACTICE

Practice what you CAN'T play - not what you CAN play

As I said earlier - divide your practice into two halves. First half, play the more difficult exercises - push yourself - repeat, repeat, repeat, repeat, repeat, repeat.

Then in the second half REWARD yourself by playing a few easier exercises or tunes. It's important to end your practice feeling relaxed and positive.

OK, LET'S GET STARTED

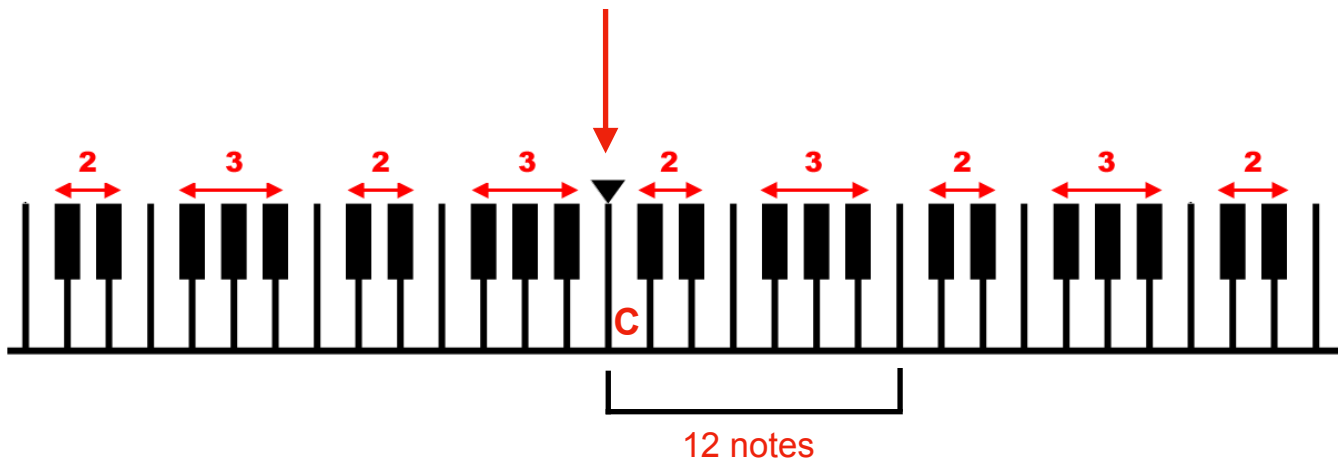


GETTING TO KNOW THE KEYBOARD

Notice how the pattern of the keys repeats itself.

See how there are two black keys then three black keys - then two again - then three and so on.

IMPORTANT! The tiny black arrow in the keyboard diagrams always indicates MIDDLE C, the C nearest the centre of your piano.



Each pattern contains the SAME 12 notes, but at higher or lower pitches.

Think of Mickey Mouse singing a high C note and Pavarotti singing a low C note. Same note but at different pitches.

You really only have 12 distinct notes to memorize!

These notes are represented by the first seven letters of the alphabet...

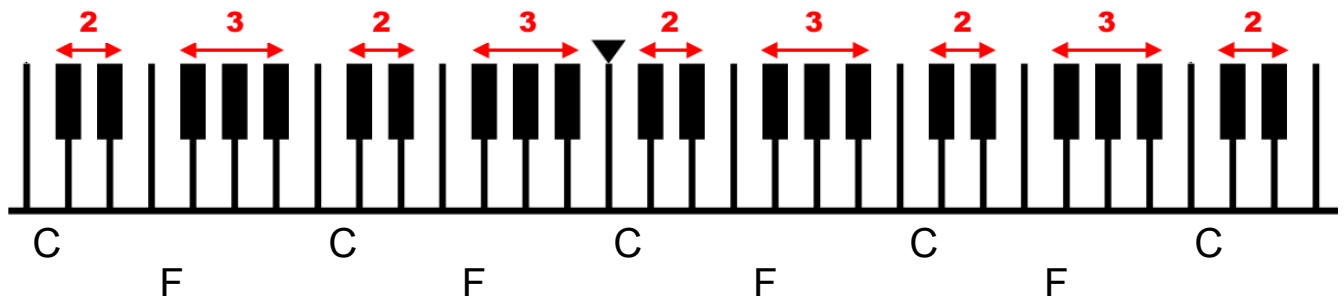
A, B, C, D, E, F and G repeated at different pitches.



It is important that you are able (eventually) to name ALL the white notes.

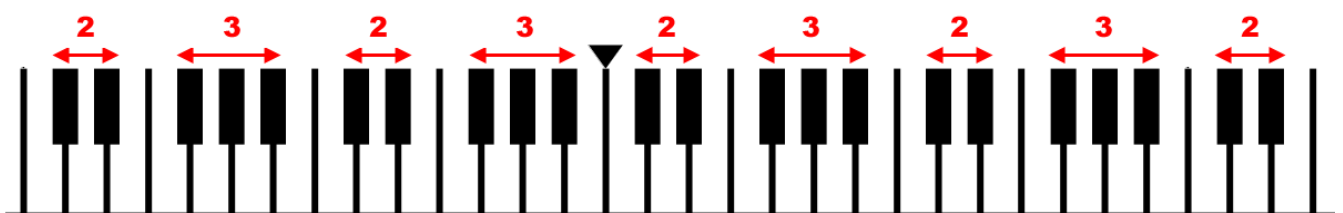
Use the pattern of the BLACK keys to help you.

For instance, notice that the C keys are the keys to the left of the '2' black keys or that the F keys are one key to left of the '3' black keys.



Using the black keys to guide you, see if you can find the following notes and where they are repeated. Keep doing this until you instantly know the name of every WHITE key on your keyboard. Spend a full day on this if you have to!

(G, B, A, F, D, C, E)

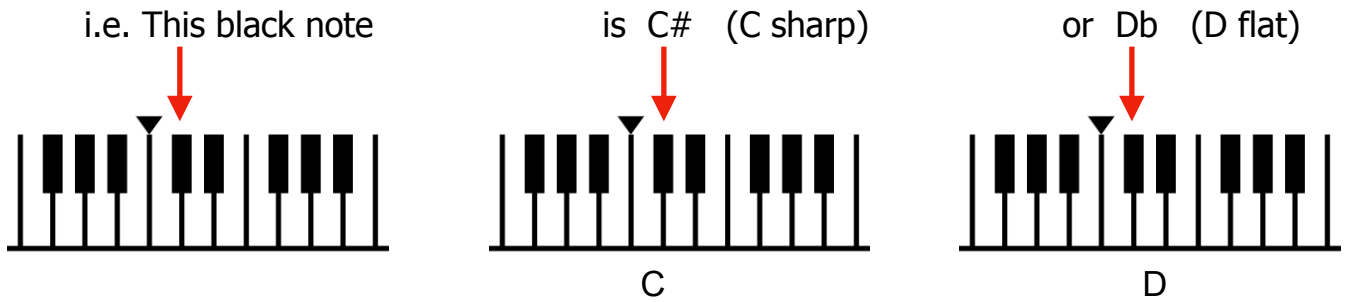


THE BLACK KEYS

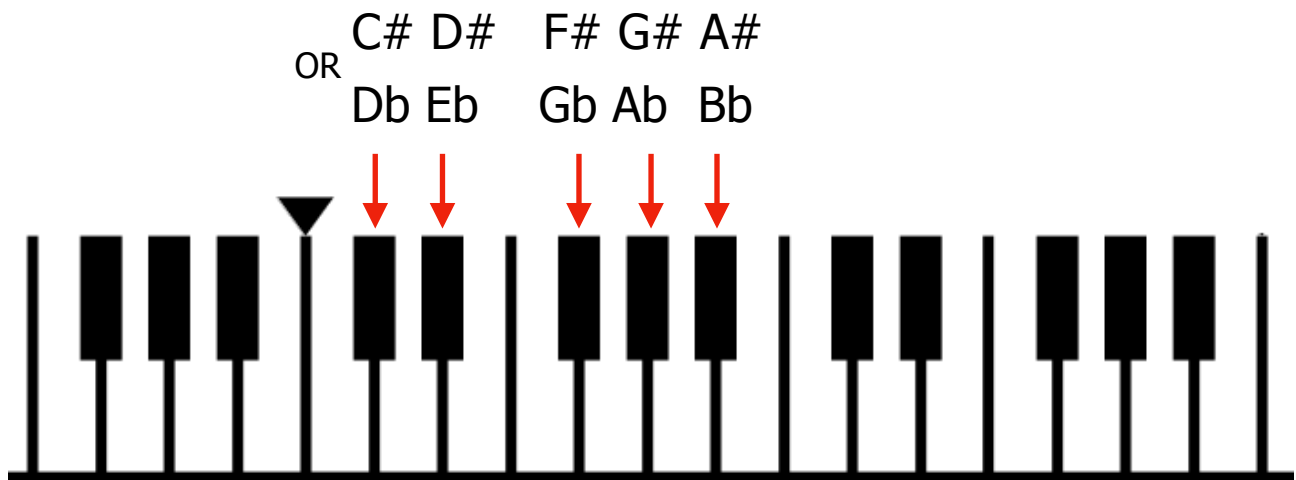
1-20

The black keys are known as either SHARPS (#) or FLATS (b)
(don't worry about WHY - just memorize it all for now)

They are named using the white key NEAREST to them on their left or right.



Can you see how the other black keys are named



REMEMBER - DON'T ASK WHY - JUST ACCEPT IT FOR NOW

CHORDS

A chord is simply 3 or more (particular) notes that when played together make a 'FULL' sound.

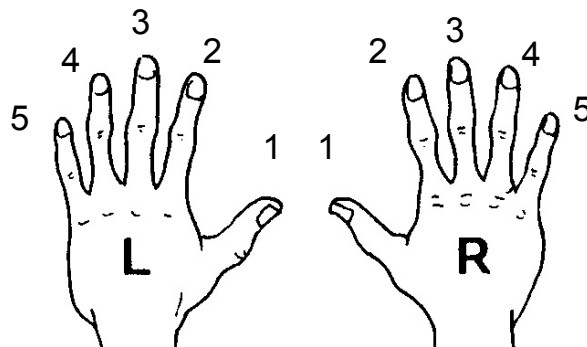
If this full sound is played rhythmically and various chords are used in a certain sequence, a nice background sound can be created for melodies or lyrics (vocals).

Let's play a very basic chord - the chord of C

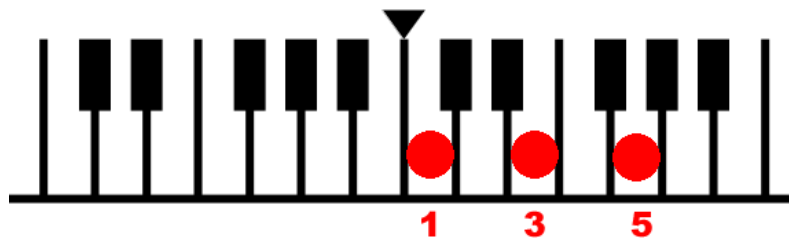
Use your right hand - THUMB - MIDDLE FINGER - SMALL FINGER.

This isn't easy to start with but TRY TRY TRY to use these fingers
It won't take long to get used to it.

For all future fingering purposes number your fingers like this.



The Chord of C
RIGHT HAND



REMEMBER play all three notes **TOGETHER** - **AT THE SAME TIME**

Play it over and over until your fingers get used to the shape.

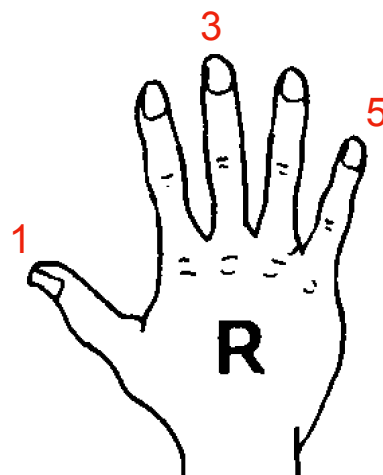
This is known as a **ROOT POSITION chord** because the note that gives the chord its name is the bottom (ROOT) note

About the FINGERING for the chords

Many beginners find it difficult using their 1st, 3rd and 5th fingers to play the basic chords.

Some find it easier to use their 1st, 2nd and 4th fingers.

So is it essential to stick to the suggested fingering?



There are a few different reasons to use the suggested fingers.

1. Beginners usually want to use what feels easier ONLY because it feels easier - but if they keep doing that they will never strengthen ALL their fingers which will be very limiting as they progress.

2. There IS a VALID reason to use your 1st, 3rd and 5th fingers for these basic root position chords. Later you are going to learn 'seventh' chords where you will be adding notes BELOW the basic chords. When you use 1 3 5 you can stretch your thumb further to the left to accommodate the added note - if you are using 1 2 4 this isn't so easy.

3. It is good to be FLEXIBLE enough to use different fingering at different times

Try using the suggested 1 3 5 for a few days - it WILL become easier.

Even just practice on a table top.

Put your hand into a 'claw' shape as if you are playing the chord of C major.

You may struggle to keep your other fingers (2nd and 4th) UP off the keys. That is perfectly normal to begin with and the more you practice the more your fingers will behave themselves :-)

A familiar tune using four VERY simple chords

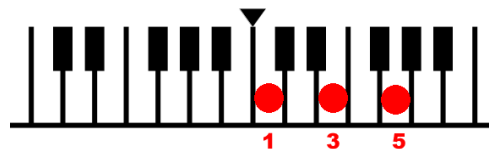
We're going to play a very familiar chord sequence using 4 simple chords.

(Don't worry about WHY a chord is the shape it is or why it is a 'major' or a 'minor' chord – just PLAY!) **PLAY FIRST ASK QUESTIONS LATER**

The 4 chords are **C**, **A minor** (written **Am**), **F** and **G**.

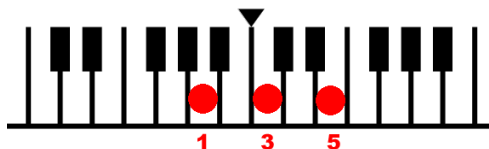
(Remember, play the three notes of each chord together - at the same time with your RIGHT HAND).

PLAY



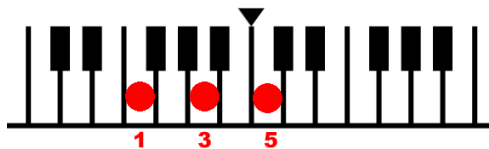
The Chord of **C**

THEN move the whole shape two notes left



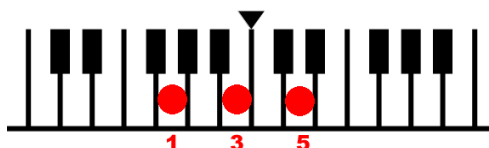
The Chord of **Am** (minor)

THEN move the whole shape two notes left



The Chord of **F**

THEN move the whole shape one note up



The Chord of **G**

Play them over and over in a repeat pattern SLOWLY.

C, Am, F, G, C, Am, F, G etc . . . (you may recognize the sequence)

These chords are in what is known as '**ROOT**' position, with the THUMB on the note that gives the chord its name – the ROOT note.

Don't give up if playing these chords hurts your hand. That's normal for a beginner and won't last forever.

Let's make it more interesting by
adding some notes in the left hand...

RHYTHM # 1

LEFT NOTE / RIGHT CHORD



RHYTHM 1 - "Left note / Right chord"

The left hand notes are the SAME note as the first note of the 'matching' right hand chord, but played an octave LOWER (8 notes to the left).

Use ANY left hand finger (for now).

PLAY LEFT HAND



C

Then RIGHT HAND



C Chord

Then LEFT HAND



A

Then RIGHT HAND



Am Chord

Then LEFT HAND



F

Then RIGHT HAND



F Chord

Then LEFT HAND



G

Then RIGHT HAND



G Chord

REPEAT

If you keep repeating this pattern you should recognize the sequence.



You DON'T use the pedal with this rhythm

LOTS of songs use this exact rhythm and chord sequence - it is actually known as the '1950s Chord Progression'

Play the sequence and see if you can SING-ALONG with any of the following songs - you may have to change the speed you play for each song. You don't have to spend a lot of time on this - its just to give you an idea of how one chord sequence can be used in MANY songs.

These aren't links - it's just a list of songs that use the progression

(Also check out a video on YouTube by 'The Axis Of Awesome - 4 chords')

Always look on bright side of life (chorus) - Eric Idle - Monty Python

All I have to do is dream - Boudleaux Bryant (covered by The Everly Brothers)

A Teenager in Love - Marty Wilde

Beyond the Sea - Jack Lawrence / Charles Trenet (cover - Frank Sinatra)

Blue Moon - Rodgers and Hart

Earth Angel - Curtis Williams (used in the film Back to the Future)

Eternal Flame - The bangles ("close your eyes - give me your hand...")

Heart and Soul - Hoagy Carmichael & Frank Loesser 1938 (used in the film 'Big' with Tom Hanks)

I will always love you (chorus) - Dolly Parton (covered by Whitney Houston)

Lollipop Lollipop O lolli lollipop - Julius Dixson (covered by Chordettes)

Lonely This Christmas - Mud (do your best Elvis impersonation)

My Boy Lollipop - Robert Spencer

Oh Donna - Ritchie Valens

Red Red Wine - Neil Diamond (the original chord progression is slightly different but the song still fits with C Am F G)

Take It On The Run - REO Speedwagon (play each chord twice)

This Boy - Beatles

Remember

If you have NEVER played piano before even basic chords can be quite difficult.

Go easy on yourself.

It takes a while for your mind to get used to the pattern of the keys.

and it takes a while for your fingers to get used to the strange shapes you are putting them in.

It will get easier the more you practice.





STUDENT Q & A

Q - Shouldn't I be learning scales and finger exercises?

A - Many students have a pre-conceived idea that they are 'meant' to start with scales and finger exercises. I have designed the course so that each exercise will naturally develop and exercise your fingers and help with two hand coordination - and you will have more fun which means you will be more motivated to keep practicing!

You can use the 'Melodic Interludes' (that you will learn in between the rhythm lessons) as warm up exercises.

In section 10 you will learn scales and arpeggio exercises in every key and you will feel more motivated to learn them AFTER being able to play some great piano by ear.

Q - I thought I would be playing chords in the left hand and melody in the right hand? How come I am playing chords in the right hand?

A - With Pianoforall you are starting with 'Rhythm Style Piano' the way people learn guitar. Rhythm Style Piano is a 100% valid piano style. It is the easiest way to learn chords and to get a professional sound right from the start.

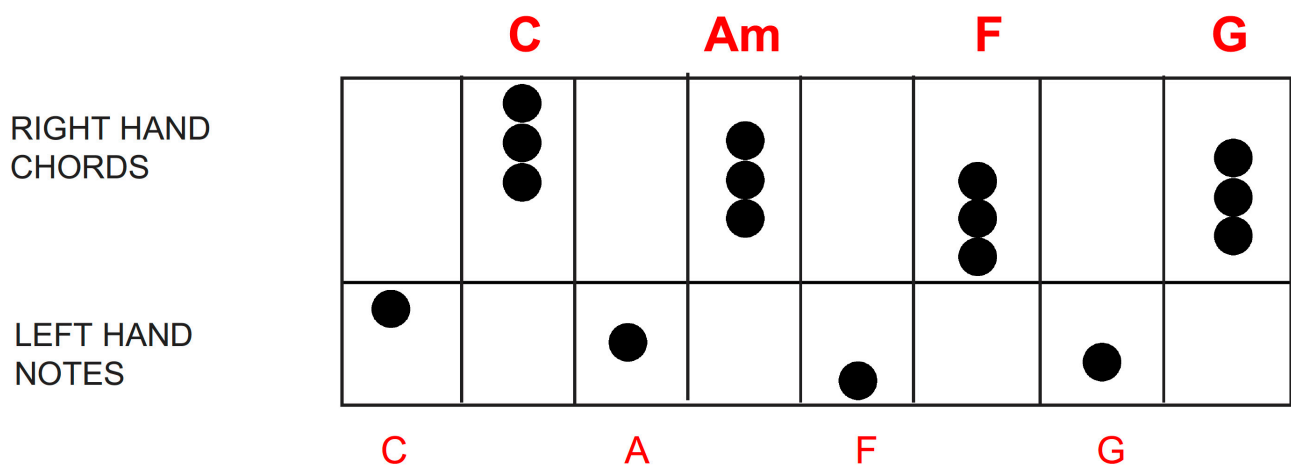
It is also essential to learn chords in BOTH hands for when you later play Ballad Style. From section 6 onwards you will play left hand chords with melody or improvisations in the right hand.

AN EASIER WAY TO WRITE IT ALL DOWN

If I had to describe everything using keyboard diagrams this book would end up about 800 pages long! Let's look at an easier way...

Imagine that the Left Hand single notes were represented by single dots and the Right Hand three-note Chords were represented by three vertical dots.

The pattern you just played could be written in the following way...



This is very similar to how proper music notation works.
Can you see the similarities?

	C		Am		F		G	
RIGHT HAND								
LEFT HAND								
	C note		A note		F note		G note	

Notice the **SHAPES & PATTERNS**

Can you see how clever music notation is?

PROPER music notation is actually the EASIEST
and most CONCISE way to describe musical ideas

So I'm going to teach you some very BASIC music notation

BUT DON'T PANIC!

At this stage
ALL you need to do is to see the music notation
in terms of **SHAPES and PATTERNS**

I will name the Left Hand notes and the Right Hand chords for you

Look at it again

	NAME OF CHORDS C Am F G			
RIGHT HAND				
LEFT HAND				
	C note	A note	F note	G note

WHAT FINGERS TO USE IN THE LEFT HAND

It's ok to learn the rhythm by just using one finger in the left hand.

But eventually you will want to use more 'economical' and logical fingering.

The simple rule is... **USE WHATEVER FINGER IS CLOSEST TO THE TARGET NOTE**

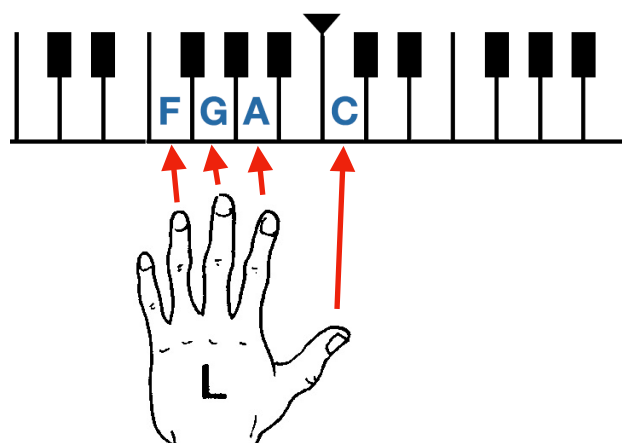
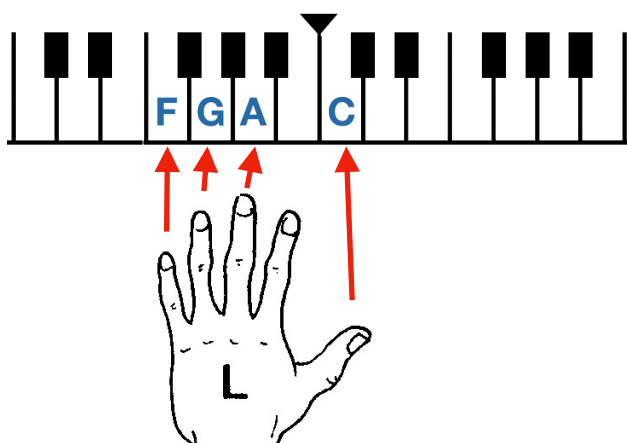
So in the Left Note/Right Chord rhythm,
the left hand moves from **C** down to **A** down to **F** up to **G**

And the closest fingers to these notes are...

thumb, 3rd, 4th and 5th fingers

OR

thumb, 2nd, 3rd and 4th fingers



Use this principle in ALL the rhythms to follow, but remember there is no ABSOLUTE rule regarding fingering and often what determines the finger is if it leads logically to the FOLLOWING note

I will write in suggested fingering. If you struggle with certain fingers please do practice using them otherwise you will never strengthen your weaker fingers



OK...

A little bit more

BASIC music notation

Just **FOUR** pages

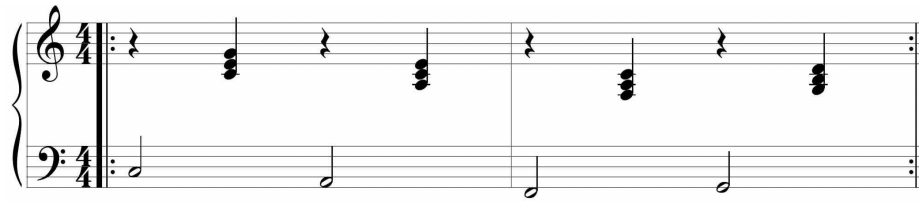
and then you'll be ready
to start playing

**YOU DON'T NEED TO
MEMORIZE ANY OF THIS**

Just **UNDERSTAND** it

You will learn more about music notation later but
this is all you need for now to get you started

So what do all the lines and symbols MEAN?



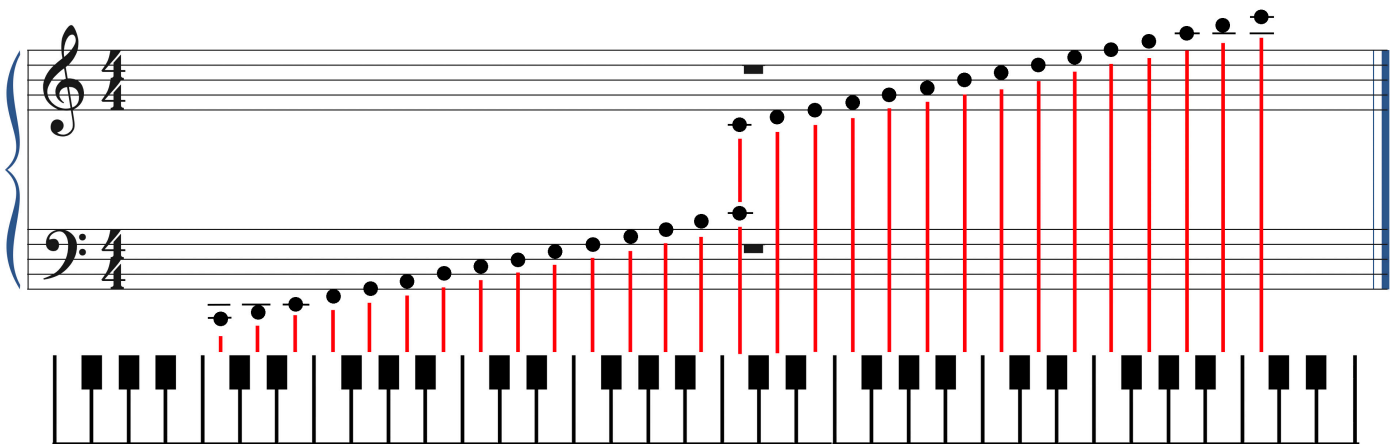
It's simple...

The TOP set of lines (and the spaces between them) represent keys to the RIGHT of middle C on your piano that are often played with the RIGHT HAND. (The symbol )

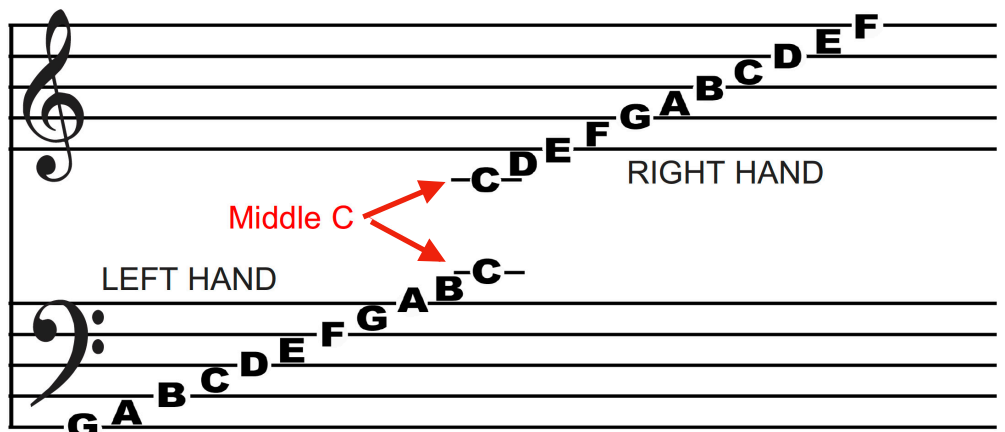
The BOTTOM set of lines (and the spaces between them) represent keys to the LEFT of middle C that are often played with your LEFT HAND. (The symbol )

The two sets of lines are 'split' at MIDDLE C - which is indicated by a separate small line either below the Right Hand lines or above the Left Hand lines

The two sets of lines (and spaces) are known as 'Staves'



This symbol is called a 'Treble Clef'



This symbol is called a 'Bass Clef'



JUST LIKE READING A BOOK

We read music in the same way that we read the sentences of a novel – from the **left of the page to the right**.

Getting back to our 'dots' on the Lines and Spaces. As we scan from left to right we play those keys (notes) that the dots on the Lines and Spaces represent.

Should there be SEVERAL dots (notes) in the SAME VERTICAL PLANE we must play these keys SIMULTANEOUSLY.

Read from left to right

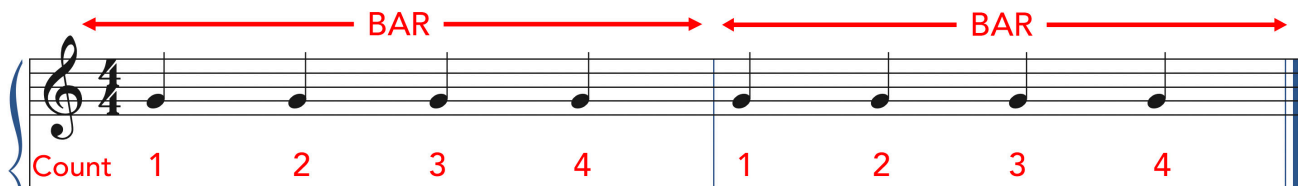
Order of play 1st 2nd 3rd 4th

BARS & BEATS

To make music easier to follow it is divided into segments called BARS.
BARS are divided into BEATS.

The most commonly used rhythm is 4 BEATS in EACH BAR.

 = 1 BEAT
US = Quarter Note
UK = Crotchet



A beat with a 'hook' on it is a HALF BEAT.
You could play up to 8 half beats in each bar.

 = 1/2 BEAT
US = Eighth Note
UK = Quaver

To make half beats easier to write out, if there are two, three or four in a row they are grouped together by joining the hooks of their tails.



So 8 HALF beats are written:



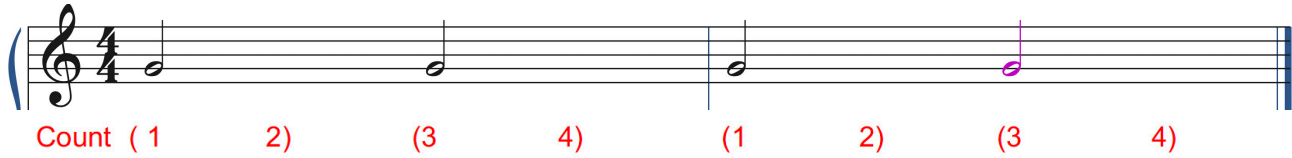
Notice that half beats are counted with the use of the word 'and' (or the symbol +).
This means we don't have to start counting out too many numbers.

Notes can be HELD for 2 beats (hold each note DOWN for 2 beats)



= 2 BEATS

US = Half Note
UK = Minum

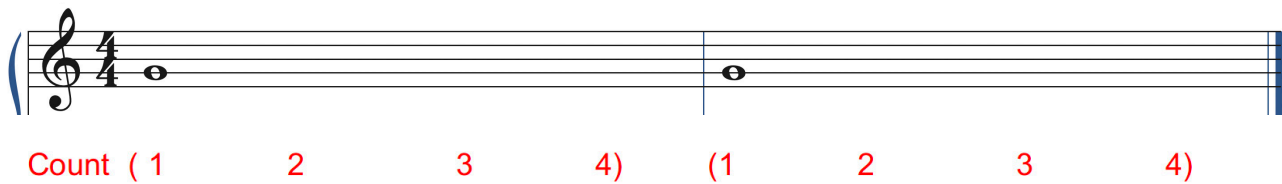


Notes can be HELD for 4 beats (hold each note DOWN for 4 beats)



= 4 BEATS

US = Whole Note
UK = Semibreve



Periods of **silence** are shown by symbols called RESTS.



NOTES AS FRACTIONS

The American names for the various notes make sense if you view them in terms of mathematical divisions or fractions

We will use the American names for notes throughout the course

Note below how the largest note value - a WHOLE NOTE - is broken down to different fractional levels

WHOLE NOTE - Lasts for 4 beats

(1) 2 3 4)

HALF NOTE - Lasts for 2 beats

(1) 2) (3 4)

QUARTER NOTE - Lasts for 1 beat

1 2 3 4

EIGHTH NOTE - Lasts for 1/2 a beat

1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &

BEATS (1 2 3 4) (1 2) (3 4) 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

The WHOLE note

is held for 4 beats

The HALF note

is held for 2 beats

The QUARTER note

is held for 1 beat

The EIGHTH note

is held for half a beat

A TUNE THAT USES THE DIFFERENT BEATS

Jingle Bells uses all the beats you have looked at so far.

You don't have to play it at the piano. Just sing the song and observe the length of the different beats. Tap the tune out on a table top and count the beats.

The image displays the first four lines of the song 'Jingle Bells' in 4/4 time. Each line of music is on a single staff with a treble clef. The lyrics are written above the notes, and red numbers below the staff indicate the beat count for each note or group of notes. The first line shows the first two measures: 'Jin gle Bells' and 'Jin gle Bells'. The second line shows measures 3 and 4: 'Jin gle all the way'. The third line shows measures 5 and 6: 'Oh what fun it is to ride in a'. The fourth line shows measures 7 and 8: 'One horse o pen sleigh hey!'. The beat counts are: Line 1 (1, 2, (3 4), 1, 2, (3 4)), Line 2 (1, 2, 3, 4, (1 2 3 4)), Line 3 (1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 4 and), Line 4 (1, 2, 3, 4, (1 2), (3 4)).

Jin gle Bells Jin gle Bells

3 Jin gle all the way

5 Oh what fun it is to ride in a

7 One horse o pen sleigh hey!

1 2 (3 4) 1 2 (3 4)

1 2 3 4 (1 2 3 4)

1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 and

1 2 3 4 (1 2) (3 4)

MEMORIZING THE LINES AND SPACES

1-39

I'm sure everyone has heard the phrase "Every Good Boy Deserves Football" and of course this is used to help memorize the lines of the Right Hand staff in musical notation.

This really IS the best way to do it. There is a special 'Note Finder' on the next page which you can print out but it is still best to use your memory.

Here are the usual tricks... Check this on your NOTE FINDER on the next page.

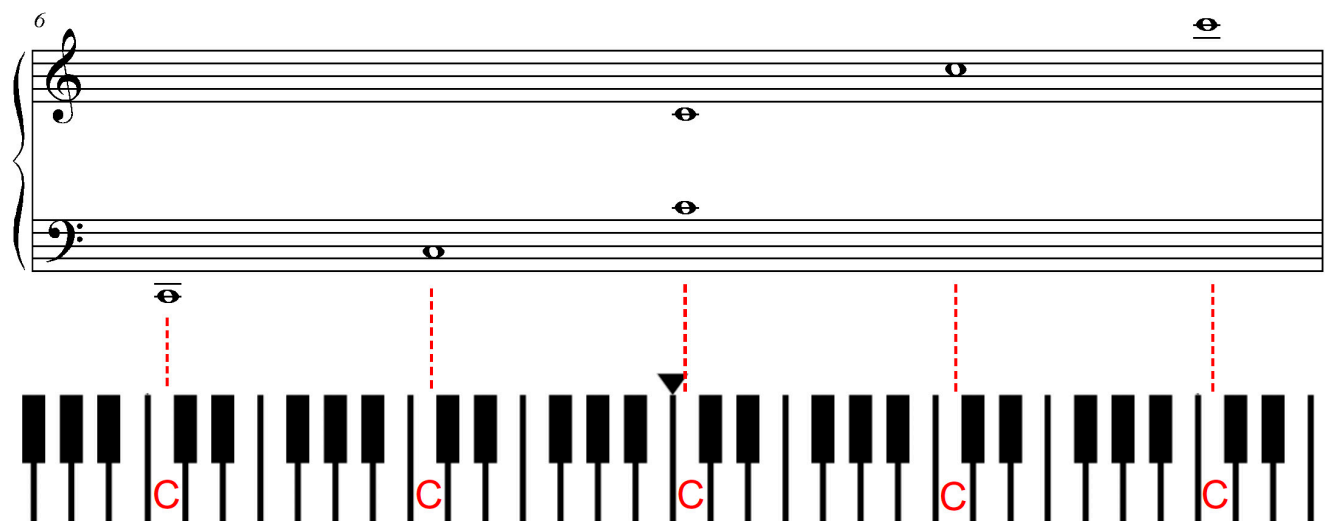
RIGHT HAND LINES	Every Good Boy Deserves Football
RIGHT HAND SPACES	F A C E

LEFT HAND LINES	Good Boys Don't Frighten Animals
LEFT HAND SPACES	A C E Garage

Then notice that the Lines and Spaces above and below the Right Hand lines have the same pattern. This is the same for the Left Hand.

USE ALL THE C NOTES AS ROUGH GUIDES

To begin with, I will write in the names of the notes for you but you STILL have to know WHERE each note is. If you memorize the position of the C notes. This will help you 'get your bearings'.



NOTE FINDER

Print this out

The diagram shows a musical staff with a treble clef and a bass clef. The treble clef staff has a yellow background and contains the following notes: E (bottom line, red), G (first space, red), B (second line, red), D (second space, red), F (third line, red), A (third space, blue), C (fourth line, blue), and E (top line, blue). The bass clef staff has a yellow background and contains the following notes: G (bottom line, red), B (first space, red), D (second line, red), F (second space, red), A (third line, blue), C (third space, blue), E (fourth line, blue), and G (top line, blue). Above the treble clef staff, there are three sets of letter labels: A (red), C (red), and G (blue) on the first line; B (blue), D (blue), and F (blue) on the second line; and C (red), B (blue), and A (blue) on the third line. Above the bass clef staff, there are three sets of letter labels: E (red), D (blue), and C (blue) on the first line; F (red), E (blue), and D (blue) on the second line; and G (red), F (blue), and E (blue) on the third line. A dashed line labeled 'MIDDLE C' points to the C note on the first line of the treble clef staff.

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Congratulations

You survived
Basic Musical Notation

It wasn't THAT bad was it...

Now let's learn
some more chords
and start playing some

PIANO!



LESSONS CHECKPOINT



1-42

- ☐ Do you have the right equipment - a 'touch sensitive' keyboard with a SUSTAIN PEDAL? - a good piano stool? Is your keyboard at the correct height?
- ☐ Have you unticked Udemy's 'autoplay' button?
- ☐ Can you name all the white keys instantly? This is ESSENTIAL!!
Play the following keys one by one in every octave.

F, A, D, G, B, E, C.

- ☐ Do you understand Rhythm Number 1 - Left Note / Right Chord?
- ☐ Can you play the chords of C, Am, F and G?
- ☐ Apply the Left Note / Right Chord rhythm to Chord progression C-Am-F-G.
- ☐ Were you able to sing any of the song list over your rhythm?
- ☐ Do you understand Basic Music Notation? bars - beats - treble clef - bass clef ? Do you know where middle C is on your keyboard?
- ☐ Do you understand why we start with RHYTHM STYLE piano?
- ☐ Do you know how to use the Udemy player? Have you unticked the 'autoplay' button? Are you able to slow the video down by half?

Please don't move on unless you can name every WHITE key on the piano INSTANTLY. There are only 7 unique white keys to remember and if you use the black keys as a guide it is easy to play each note in any octave.

Even if it takes a week to learn this you HAVE to do it!

LET ME INTRODUCE YOU TO THE

EASY-TO-PLAY

ALL WHITE KEYS

C FAMILY CHORDS



The Easy 'All White Keys' C Family Chords

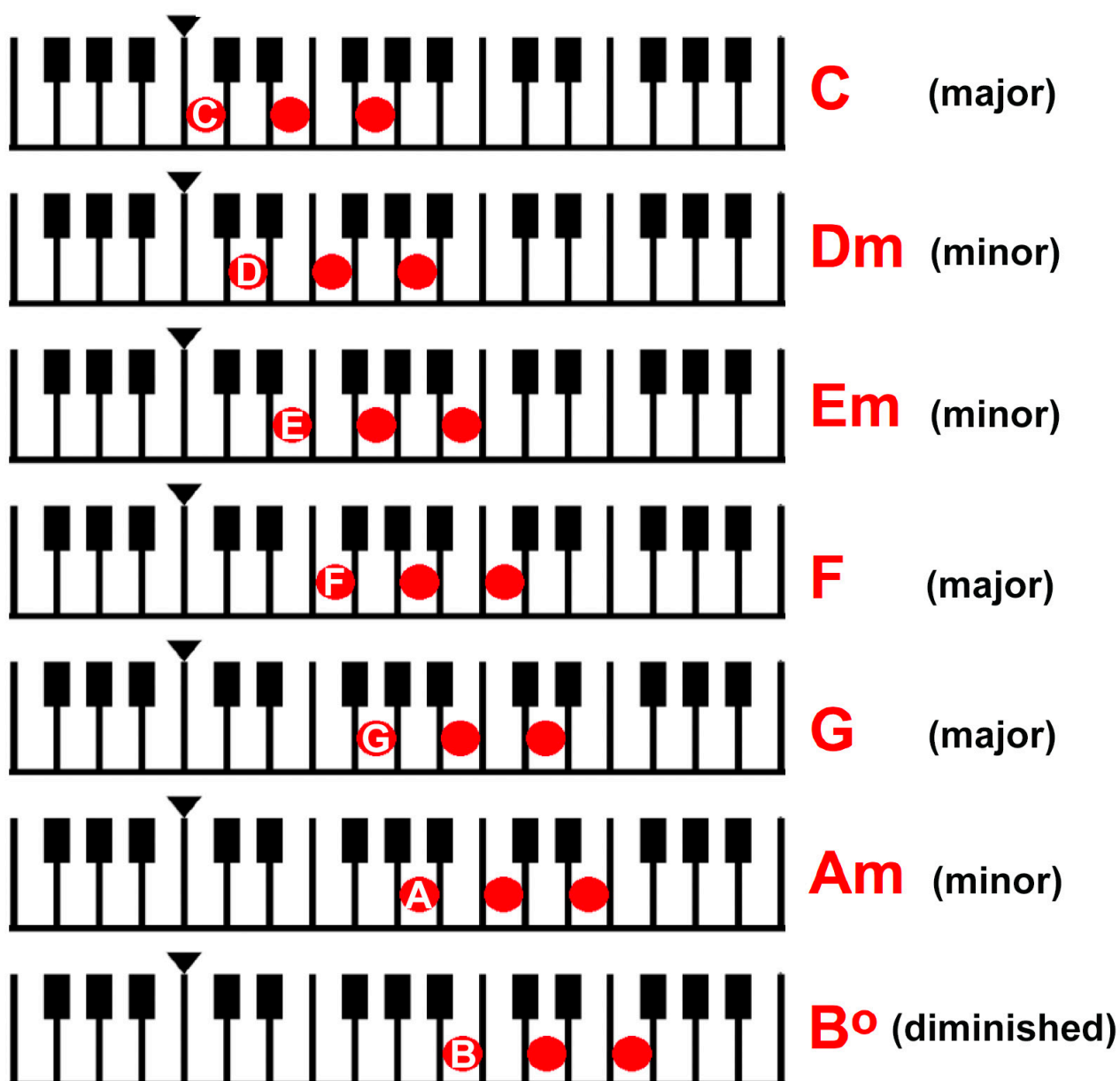
If you play the white notes from one C note to another (from LEFT to RIGHT) you will have played the scale of C (major)... **C D E F G A B C**

A chord can be built on each of these notes, giving you seven chords. Three are called major chords, three are minor chords and one is a 'diminished' chord.

DON'T WORRY WHY – JUST MEMORIZE!

Here are the chords.

(The major chords don't use any symbol for major. i.e. C Major is written simply as C)



The Easy 'All White Keys' C Family Chords

It is really helpful to memorize all the chords you learn so that you can play them the instant you see them written in a song.

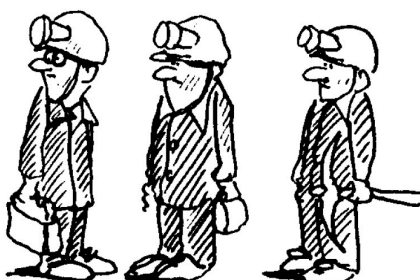
The 7 chords in the C Family are really easy to remember.

There are 3 MAJORS, 3 MINORS, and 1 'DIMINISHED'



3 MAJORS

C F G



3 MINORS

Dm Em Am



1 'DIMINISHED'

B^o

Use the word '**D E A D**' to help you remember the 3 MINOR chords.

Then remember that the DIMINISHED chord is the LAST one in the scale
B diminished (the last born - the baby of the family)

Then the three that are left are the MAJORS **C, F, G**

PLAY THEM AND SAY THEM...



C



Dm



Em



F



G



Am



B^o

LET'S PUT THE C FAMILY CHORDS TO USE



RHYTHM # 2

STRAIGHT BEAT



RHYTHM NUMBER 2

STRAIGHT BEAT

Remember the first chord sequence you played ? **C Am F G**

First of all you played each chord once in the right hand.
Then you played a left hand note followed by the right hand chord.

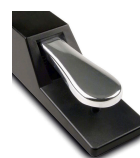
OK now let's try it another way.

Play each chord TWICE - SLOWLY with your RIGHT hand

So TWO beats for EACH chord **C C Am Am F F G G**

Along with the FIRST of the two beats play the ROOT note of the chord (the note that gives the chord its name) one or two octaves lower down the keyboard with the LEFT hand.

Keep the pedal down over each chord change



(note - these 3 chords are played below middle C)

RIGHT HAND CHORDS **C Am F G**

SLOWLY

LEFT HAND NOTES **C A F G**

COUNT 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

Remember - this chord sequence is used in songs like:

BLUE MOON, HEART & SOUL, OH WON'T YOU STAY, ALL I HAVE TO DO IS DREAM, ALWAYS LOOK ON THE BRIGHT SIDE OF LIFE and many more.

USING THE SUSTAIN PEDAL

When you press the sustain pedal down, any note that is played will be 'sustained'.

i.e. the sound will keep going as long as you hold the pedal down even if you lift your fingers off the keys.



As soon as you lift your foot OFF the pedal, the sustain will stop so the note will stop sounding.

If a song uses sustain pedal - it generally means that the pedal will be held DOWN over the majority of the tune.

You will only lift the pedal briefly, and replace it again VERY quickly, when you change chords or measures.

You want to get a balance between too much sustain and not enough sustain.

It will be easy to tell if you are not using the pedal enough because the sound will be very abrupt and staccato.

It is more difficult to know if you are using too MUCH pedal. You need to listen to your own playing very carefully.

Let's try the progression again and pay close attention to the pedaling. Remember, lift and replace the pedal VERY quickly between chord changes.

The musical notation is in 4/4 time and consists of two staves. The top staff is in treble clef and the bottom staff is in bass clef. The progression is as follows:

- Measure 1:** Treble clef has a C4 chord (C-E-G). Bass clef has a C4 note. A red 'C' is above the treble staff and a red 'C' is below the bass staff.
- Measure 2:** Treble clef has an Am4 chord (A-C-E). Bass clef has an A3 note. A red 'Am' is above the treble staff and a red 'A' is below the bass staff.
- Measure 3:** Treble clef has an F4 chord (F-A-C). Bass clef has an F3 note. A red 'F' is above the treble staff and a red 'F' is below the bass staff.
- Measure 4:** Treble clef has a G4 chord (G-B-D). Bass clef has a G3 note. A red 'G' is above the treble staff and a red 'G' is below the bass staff.

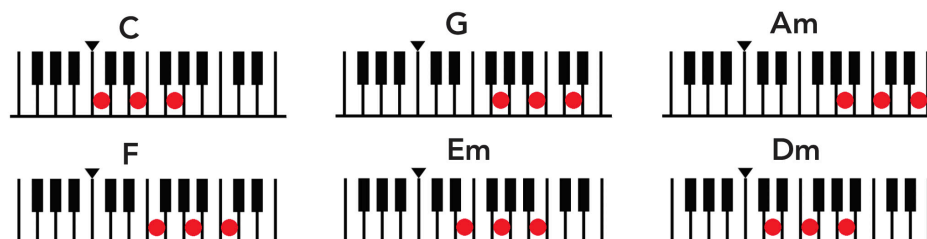
Red double-headed arrows labeled 'PEDAL' are placed between the staves, indicating the pedal is held down from the start of Measure 1 to the start of Measure 2, from Measure 2 to Measure 3, from Measure 3 to Measure 4, and from Measure 4 to the end of the sequence.

Straight Beat

Practice Progression

The following chord sequence is another very common progression used in many slow songs such as 'Let it Be' or 'No Woman No Cry'.

CHORDS USED



PEDAL over each chord change

RH CHORDS

C G Am F

Musical notation for the first part of the progression. The right hand (RH) plays chords C, G, Am, and F. The left hand (LH) plays single notes C, G, A, and F. Red arrows labeled "PEDAL" indicate the pedal point over each chord change. The text "etc" is written after the Am chord.

LH Notes

C G A F

Musical notation for the second part of the progression. The right hand (RH) plays chords C, G, F, Em, Dm, and C. The left hand (LH) plays single notes C, G, F, and C. A triplet of eighth notes is shown in the RH for the C chord.



The STRAIGHT BEAT rhythm can be played with or without the pedal. If it is a slow song (like Let It Be) then you use the pedal over each chord change. If it is a fast tempo song then you won't need to use the pedal.

I will indicate in the videos whether to use it or not.

Straight Beat VARIATIONS

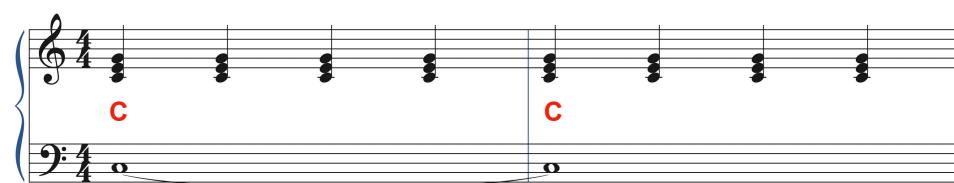
A 'Straight Beat' rhythm is any rhythm where the right hand plays steadily on the main beat (which can be single beats or half beats) and where the left hand - when played - is played exactly on one or more of the right hand beats.

So we could have several variations:

One chord in each bar (RH = 4 straight beats, LH = played on first beat of each bar)

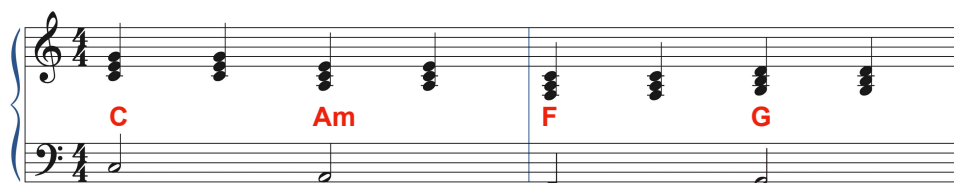


Same chord over 2 bars (RH = 4 straight beats per bar, LH = played on first beat of the first bar and held over the 2 bars)

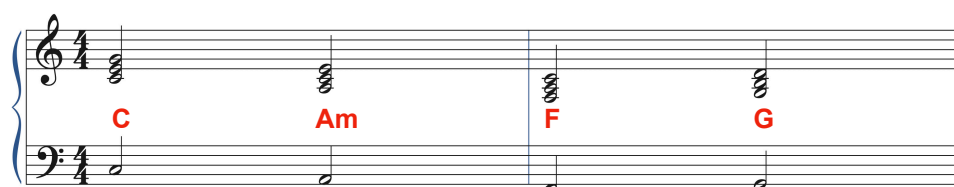


The curved line connecting the 2 bass notes is called a 'tie' and indicates that the note is HELD over the two bars

Two chords per bar (2 beats for each chord)



Two chords per bar - each chord is just played once and held

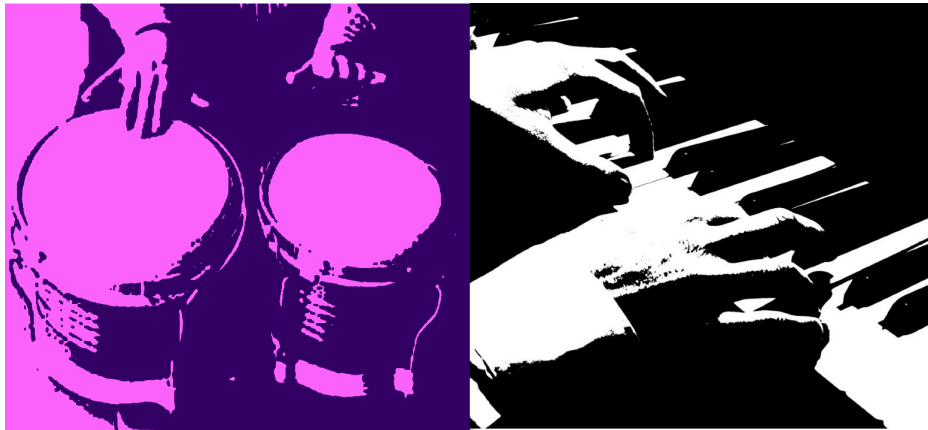


Eight X eighth notes per bar (count "1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and")



DON'T USE
THE PEDAL
WITH THIS
VERSION

About The Practice Progressions



How to follow the Practice Progressions

In the practice chord progressions throughout the course, you will see chord symbols either written above lyrics or inside boxes.

If you see one chord in a box, you play that chord for 4 beats in the specified rhythm. (Later when you learn the 3 Beat Bounce Rhythm each box will denote 3 beats per bar)

RHYTHM: Straight Beat (In the style of... Hey Jude - Beatles)

This little line under the key indicates the MIDDLE C key



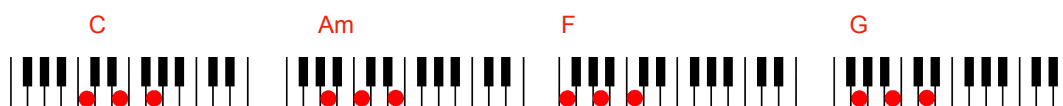
C	G	G	C	F	C	G	C
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

One Bar 4 beats One Bar 4 beats One Bar 4 beats One Bar 4 beats One Bar 4 beats One Bar 4 beats One Bar 4 beats One Bar 4 beats

Play a C chord for 4 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm	Play a G chord for 4 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm	Play a G chord for 4 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm	Play a C chord for 4 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm	Play an F chord for 4 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm	Play a C chord for 4 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm	Play a G chord for 4 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm	Play a C chord for 4 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm
---	---	---	---	--	---	---	---

If you see TWO chords in a box you play each chord for 2 beats.

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (In the style of... Blue Moon)



C	Am	F	G	repeat
---	----	---	---	--------

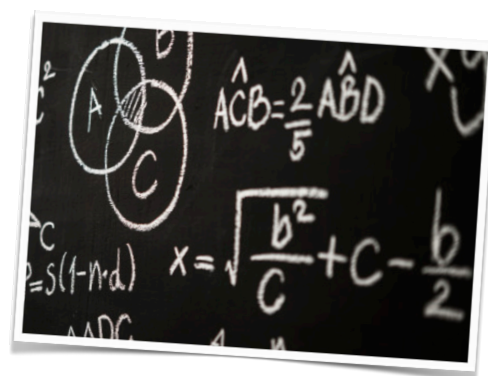
← One Bar 4 beats → ← One Bar 4 beats →

Play a C chord for 2 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm	Play an Am chord for 2 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm	Play an F chord for 2 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm	Play a G chord for 2 beats using Straight Beat Rhythm
---	---	--	---

These Rhythms Are FORMULAS

It is important to understand that the rhythms you will be learning in section 1 are FORMULAS that can be applied to ANY chord.

You first learn how to play the rhythm for ONE chord, which explains what to play in BOTH hands.

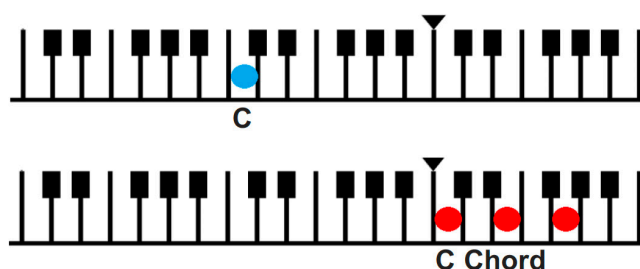


So you basically learn a 'FORMULA' for the Rhythm.

For instance - the first rhythm you learned was called **Left Note / Right Chord**.

The 'formula' for the 'Left Note / Right Chord' Rhythm is..
Play a Left Hand bass note followed by the Right Hand chord
 (and the left hand bass note is the ROOT note of the Right hand chord)

ie. If we are playing a C chord, and we apply the Left Note / Right Chord formula, we play a C bass note followed by a C chord in the right hand.



If the next chord in the progression is an Am chord we simply APPLY the EXACT SAME formula to the chord of Am - which means we play an A note in the left hand followed by an Am chord in the right hand.

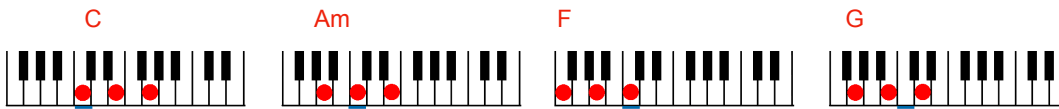
And we just follow the same process for ALL chords in the progression.

So - even though the progressions just show the CHORD - you will be applying the formula (which shows what to play in BOTH hands) TO that chord.

APPLYING the Left Note / Right Chord Rhythm 'Formula' to a Progression

1-55

RHYTHM: Left Note / Right Chord (LN/RC) (In the style of... Blue Moon)



C	Am	F	G	repeat
---	----	---	---	--------

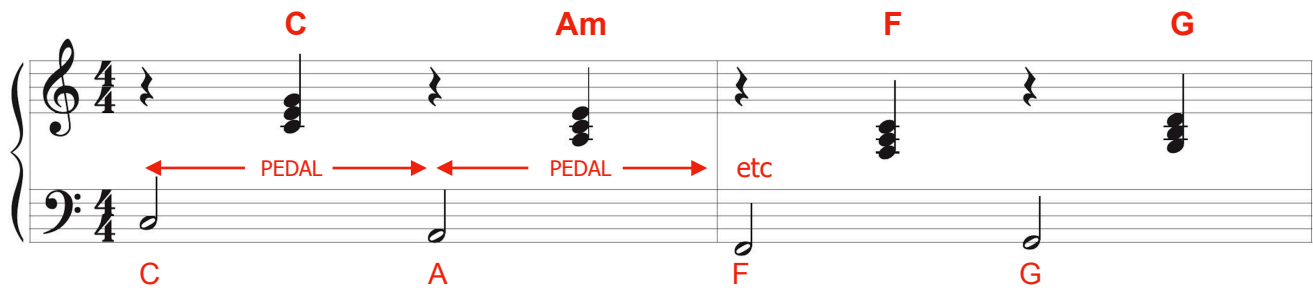
← One Bar 4 beats → ← One Bar 4 beats →

Play a C chord
for 2 beats using
LN/RC Rhythm

Play an Am chord
for 2 beats using
LN/RC Rhythm

Play an F chord
for 2 beats using
LN/RC Rhythm

Play a G chord
for 2 beats using
LN/RC Rhythm



BAR 1 BEAT 1 = Left Note



BEAT 2 = Right Chord



BEAT 3 = Left Note



BEAT 4 = Right Chord



BAR 2 BEAT 1 = Left Note



BEAT 2 = Right Chord



BEAT 3 = Left Note

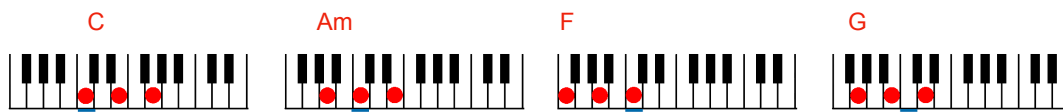


BEAT 4 = Right Chord



APPLYING the Straight Beat Rhythm 'Formula' to a Progression

RHYTHM: Straight Beat (In the style of... Blue Moon)



C	Am	F	G	<i>repeat</i>
---	----	---	---	---------------

← One Bar 4 beats → ← One Bar 4 beats →

Play a C chord
for 2 beats using
Straight Beat
Rhythm

Play an Am chord
for 2 beats using
Straight Beat
Rhythm

Play an F chord
for 2 beats using
Straight Beat
Rhythm

Play a G chord
for 2 beats using
Straight Beat
Rhythm

BAR 1 BEAT 1



BEAT 2



BEAT 3



BEAT 4



BAR 2 BEAT 1



BEAT 2



BEAT 3



BEAT 4



This course is not about teaching particular songs. You are going to learn MUCH more than that!

The course is teaching you ESSENTIAL techniques that you HAVE to know in order to PLAY (or COMPOSE) any song in any genre.

I don't use sheet music, melody lines, lyrics or sing the melody of any copyrighted songs. I start you off with 4 to 8 bars of suitable songs that work with each rhythm - and if you want to play the complete song all you need is the rest of the lyrics and chords.

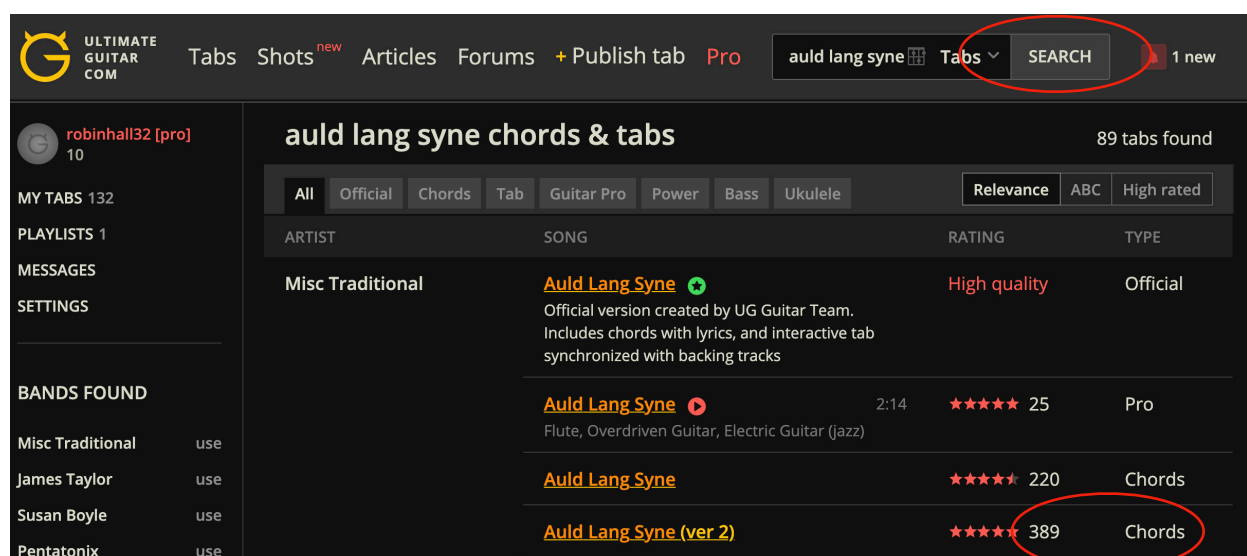
****YOU DON'T NEED THE SHEET MUSIC AT THIS STAGE****

Remember you are starting with RHYTHM STYLE piano - You are NOT playing the MELODY (you will learn how to do that later) - For now you ONLY need the chords, lyrics and rhythm style.

If you do a search online you will find lots of sites that give you the rest of the chords and the lyrics. I recommend ultimate-guitar.com because they pay artists for the use of their songs.

Just use their FREE search box (you DON'T need to join the site)

Type in the song and then **choose the top result with CHORDS** (NOT 'Pro')



The screenshot shows the Ultimate Guitar website interface. At the top, there is a search bar with the text 'auld lang syne' entered. To the right of the search bar is a 'SEARCH' button, which is circled in red. Below the search bar, the results for 'auld lang syne chords & tabs' are displayed, showing 89 tabs found. The results are filtered by 'All' and 'Official'. The first result is 'Auld Lang Syne' by 'Misc Traditional', which is marked as 'Official' and 'High quality'. Below this, there are three more results, each with a star rating and a number of tabs. The third result, 'Auld Lang Syne (ver 2)', has a star rating of 5 stars and 389 tabs, which is circled in red. The fourth result, 'Auld Lang Syne', has a star rating of 4 stars and 220 tabs. The fifth result, 'Auld Lang Syne (ver 2)', has a star rating of 5 stars and 389 tabs, which is also circled in red.

ARTIST	SONG	RATING	TYPE
Misc Traditional	Auld Lang Syne	High quality	Official
	Auld Lang Syne	2:14	Pro
	Auld Lang Syne	★★★★★ 25	Chords
	Auld Lang Syne (ver 2)	★★★★★ 389	Chords

I have created a video to show how to find lyrics and chords online and also how to change the key of the songs if you need to.



STUDENT Q & A

Q - The progressions on Ultimate Guitar and other chord sites don't look like the progressions in Pianoforall?

A - In Ultimate Guitar you get the chords written above the lyrics. Keep in mind the chords may not always be above the exact word - so be prepared to tweak it a bit.

```
[Verse 1]
      G              D
Should auld acquaintance be forgot,
    Em              C
And never brought to mind?
```

Sites like Ultimate Guitar have their limitations - because they are geared towards 'guitar' and the progressions are created by regular guitarists who use the sites so sometimes they aren't great when it comes to piano versions ie with the song Piano Man



STUDENT Q & A

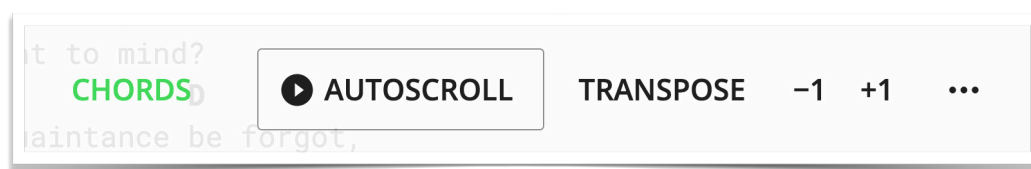
Q - Some of the progressions on Ultimate Guitar use different chords than you are using in the progressions in Pianoforall?

A - Songs are often written using chords that suit the vocal range of the composer of the song and some of these chords may be ones you haven't learned yet - so with these songs I have to change the 'key' of the song so that it uses only chords you have learned - this is called 'transposing'. Basically it is just raising or lowering the overall pitch of the song. You may have heard singers tell a pianist to play in a particular key that suits their voice.

Dont worry too much about the theory behind this. Just accept for now that you may have to transpose some of the songs you find online to suit the chord progressions that I use in Pianoforall

TRANSPOSING IN ULTIMATE GUITAR

You will see the 'Transpose' function near the bottom of the screen. Just keep hitting the plus or minus until the first chord of the progression matches the first chord of the progression in Pianoforall.



If the transpose function isn't active you can just copy the whole progression (with the lyrics) and transpose it in the free software at logue.net

A Note about using Ultimate-Guitar for chords and lyrics

I have explained in Section 1, that if you want to apply the rhythms to complete songs you can get the rest of the chords and lyrics on various chord websites online.

I recommend Ultimate-Guitar.com because they pay royalties to artists for use of their songs. But please be aware that any 'black key' chords on Ultimate Guitar BY DEFAULT are shown as sharps - not flats

So if I show a progression with all flat chords (like Bb, Eb or Ab) - on ultimate guitar the chords will show as sharp chords (ie A#, F#, G#)

For example - if I give a few bars of 'Auld Lang Syne' in the key of F major (which has Bb in it) - when you go to ultimate guitar to get the rest of the lyrics and chords you will notice they (incorrectly) use A# instead of Bb

F	C
Should	auld acquaintance be forgot,
Dm	A#
And never brought to mind?	

So you need to **CHANGE THE SETTINGS IN ULTIMATE GUITAR**

Simply click on the 3 vertical dots at the bottom of the screen and then choose 'USE FLATS' from the menu

And remember - if your next search is for a song that has SHARP chords then you need to change this back again

The screenshot shows the Ultimate-Guitar app interface for the song 'Auld Lang Syne' by Robert Burns. The lyrics and chords are displayed. The 'More' settings menu is open on the right, showing options like 'Dark mode', 'Tuner', 'Show chords', 'Chords for...', 'Transpose', 'Use Flats', 'Chords font color', 'Highlight chords', 'Left handed', 'Font size', and 'Typeface'. The 'Use Flats' toggle is currently turned on (green), and it is circled in red. The bottom navigation bar has a three-dot menu icon circled in red.



STUDENT Q & A

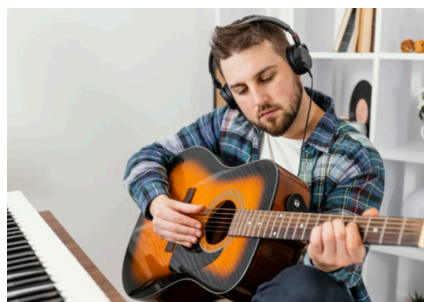
Q - The rhythms don't sound like the songs!! What am I doing wrong?!

A - In the first 5 sections *don't expect to hear a melody line.*

You are starting with RHYTHM STYLE piano - which is an ACCOMPANIMENT style.

This is the same way most people learn guitar.

It's a great way to sound reasonably professional right away.



and it teaches you essential chord knowledge which you will be using LATER when you DO start playing melodies from section 6 onwards.



So - please bear with the first 5 sections even if you aren't much of a singer,

you WILL learn a lot :-)

STRAIGHT BEAT RHYTHM

PRACTICE PROGRESSIONS

C FAMILY CHORDS



A note about the progressions

1-63

Mostly in the course, the progressions are shown as chords in boxes (no lyrics) where one box represents one bar (measure). These chord 'boxes' clearly show how many chords are to be played in each bar.

RHYTHM: Straight Beat (Auld Lang Syne)

The diagram illustrates the chord progression for 'Auld Lang Syne' in Straight Beat rhythm. It consists of five piano keyboard diagrams, each with red dots indicating the notes of the chord: C (C4, E4, G4), Am (A3, C4, E4), Dm (D4, F4, A3), G (B3, D4, F#4), and F (A3, C4, E4). Below these, a bar structure shows the chords grouped into measures: C (2 beats) and Am (2 beats) in the first measure; Dm (2 beats) and G (2 beats) in the second measure; C (4 beats) in the third measure; and F (4 beats) in the fourth measure.

But I have also included some public domain songs where I can show the lyrics with the chords above - the way you will see it on chord sites like ultimate guitar.

For example:

C Am Dm G
Should old acquaintance be for - got,
C F
And never brought to mind?

The problem with this type of progression is there is no clear indication of how many beats each chord is to be played for

YOU have to decide that based on the melody and the lyrics. So you play each chord until the chord above the lyrics changes.

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (Auld Lang Syne - New Years Eve favourite)



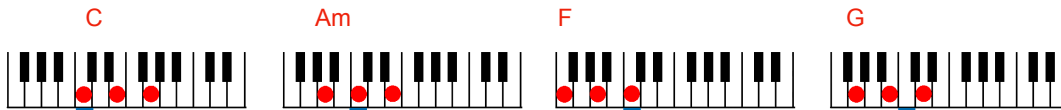
C Am Dm G
 Should old acquaintance be for - got,
 C F
 And never brought to mind?
 C Am Dm G
 Should old acquaintance be for - got,
 F G C
 And the days of auld lang syne?

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (Carrickfergus - Van Morrison/Brian Kennedy/Ronan Keating/Bryan Ferry)



(C) Dm G C Am
 I wish I was, in Carrickfergus.
 Dm G C
 Only for nights, in Ballygrand.
 Dm G C Am
 I would swim over, the deepest ocean
 Dm G C
 The deepest ocean, to be by your side.

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (Blue Moon / All I Have To Do Is Dream / It'll Be Lonely This Christmas)



C	Am	F	G	repeat
---	----	---	---	--------

PEDAL over each chord change

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (In the style of... Let It Be - Beatles)



C	G	Am	F	C	G	F	Em	Dm	C
---	---	----	---	---	---	---	----	----	---

PEDAL over each chord change

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (In the style of... No Woman No Cry - Bob Marley)



Chorus

C	G	Am	F	C	F	Em	Dm	C	G
---	---	----	---	---	---	----	----	---	---

PEDAL over each chord change

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (In the style of... Lean On Me - Bill Withers)



Don't use the PEDAL - but 'hold down' the chords where indicated - Watch the Video

"1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and 1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and"

C	C	Dm	Em	F	(hold)	F	Em	Dm	C
(hold)	C	Dm	Em	Em/G	(hold)	Dm/G			
C	C	Dm	Em	F	(hold)	F	Em	Dm	C
(hold)	C	Dm	Em	Bdim/G	(hold)	C			

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (In the style of... When A Man Loves A Woman - Michael Bolton)



C	G	Am	C	F	G	C	G
---	---	----	---	---	---	---	---

PEDAL over each chord change

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (In the style of... Somewhere Only We Know - Keane)



8 half beats per bar

C	Em	Dm	F	G	repeat
---	----	----	---	---	--------

Don't use the PEDAL in this progression

Listen to the original songs on YouTube first

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (In the style of... Say Something - A Great Big World)



Intro & Verses (Hit each chord TWICE)

Am	F	C	G	<i>repeat</i>
----	---	---	---	---------------

PEDAL over each chord change

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (In the style of... When We Were Young - Adele)



SLOW - Hit each chord ONCE

Am	Em	F	C	Dm	C	<i>repeat</i>
----	----	---	---	----	---	---------------

PEDAL over each chord change

RHYTHM: STRAIGHT BEAT (In the style of... Too Good At Goodbyes - Sam Smith)



SLOW - Hit each chord ONCE

Dm	F	C	Gm *	<i>repeat</i>
----	---	---	------	---------------

PEDAL over each chord change

* This is a new chord 'Gm' which you will come across a lot and it's easy to play. Just play a G chord and then move the middle note down onto the Bb



STUDENT Q & A

Q - I don't know these songs - what do I do?

A - I have tried my best to choose a wide variety of well known popular songs for the practice progressions but I realise not everyone will know them. Keep in mind that as you learn more chords and rhythms there will be a greater number of songs to choose from.

The best way to familiarise yourself with the songs is to listen to them on YouTube. Keep in mind that the original may be in a different key so you may not be able to 'play along' with them.

You can also just consider the practice progressions as EXERCISES for the chords and rhythms and try your best to play through all of them.

As you progress through the course you will hopefully encounter more songs that you know.

Q - I see the chords in the boxes for the right hand - so what do I do with my left hand?

A - The Progression boxes are showing the chord to be used for the rhythm in BOTH hands

Remember - when you learn a rhythm you learn a FORMULA that you apply in BOTH HANDS to any given chord or series of chords (progression)

If this isn't clear you may need to go back a few chapters

MELODIC INTERLUDE #1



The Amazing Broken Chord Ballad

AN IMPRESSIVE 'BROKEN CHORD' BALLAD
THAT USES ALL THE BASIC

C FAMILY CHORDS

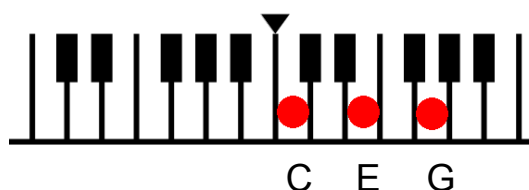
The Amazing Broken Chord Ballad

This ballad is a GREAT way to learn all your chords in both hands and all the white keys on the keyboard.

It is SO easy yet it sounds really fancy and complicated!
Everyone will be VERY impressed!

Once you learn the sequence using ONE chord it's really easy to play the rest of the tune.

Think first of all about the **chord of C** in your **RIGHT HAND**.



Now instead of playing the three notes at the SAME time play them **ONE AT A TIME** starting with C .

So play the **C** note with your **THUMB**.

Then play the **E** note with your **MIDDLE** finger.

Then play the **G** note with your **PINKY** finger. (5th finger)

This is called a 'BROKEN CHORD'
and here's how it looks in Music Notation.



OK...so far so good!

Now try playing the SAME thing but with your LEFT HAND.

So play the **C** note with your **PINKY** finger (Left Hand)

Then play the **E** note with your **MIDDLE** finger (Left Hand)

then play the **G** note with your **THUMB** (Left Hand)

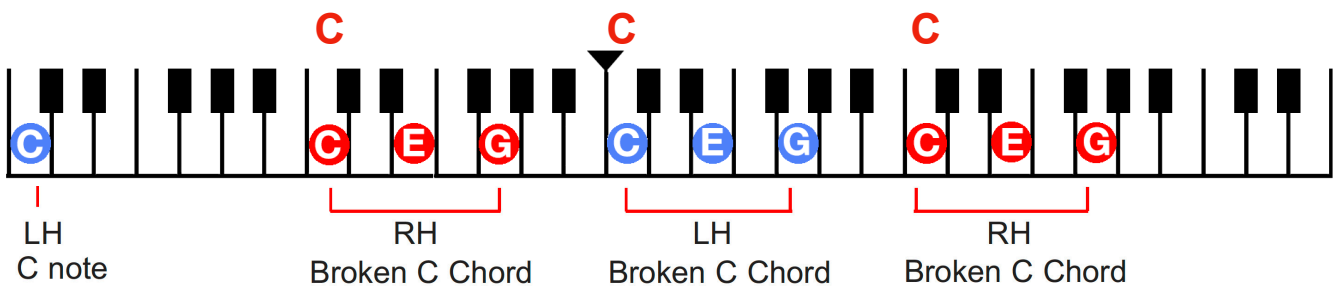
Great - now go to Part 2 

Hopefully you can now play the chord of C as a BROKEN CHORD in both hands.

Now for the exciting part.

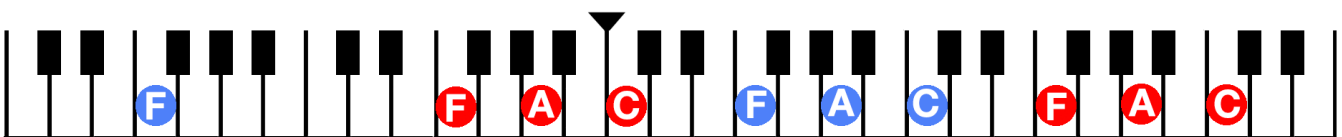
You're going to make a SWEEPING 'melody line' using broken chords.

1. Play a SINGLE C note two octaves (16 keys) to the left of middle C in your LEFT HAND (any finger).
2. Then play a broken C chord one octave (8 keys) up from that note in your RIGHT HAND.
3. Then lift your LEFT HAND over your right and play a broken C chord another octave up in your LEFT HAND.
4. Finally sweep your right hand under the left and play a broken C chord another octave up in your RIGHT HAND.



Keep the SUSTAIN pedal down throughout.

Now see if you can play the same pattern but THIS time use the chord of F.



GET THE IDEA?

To play the entire tune use the pattern with the following chord sequence.

C, F, B^o, Em, Am, Dm, G, C

(End the tune on an 'extra' single C note)

The keyboard diagrams on the next page will give the location of the notes.

How to remember the sequence

You don't want to rely on sheet music or even having to look at the chord progressions to play the piece - you want to MEMORIZE the sequence so you can sit down at any piano and just play it!

Use the black keys as a guide to easily remember the sequence of chords.

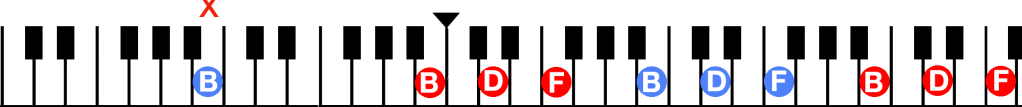
C - one key to the LEFT of the TWO black keys



F - one key to the LEFT of the THREE black keys



B diminished - one key to the RIGHT of the THREE black keys
(Also note that the next four chords will be spelling the word 'B E A D')



Em - one key to the RIGHT of the TWO black keys



Am - second 'gap' of the three black keys



Dm - middle of the TWO black keys



G - first 'gap' of the three black keys



(and then we end with a repeat of the C pattern)

As Musical Notation



Keep the sustain pedal down throughout EACH bar

CHORDS C C C F F F ^{*}B^o B^o B^o

LH RH 5 3 1 1 3 5 ETC

Count 1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and 5 and

CHORDS Em Em Em Am Am Am Dm Dm Dm

CHORDS G G G C C C C (end on a C note)

NOTE - The above notation is in '5/4' time which means there are 5 beats in each bar.
As you play you can count each bar as "1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and 5 and"

You are VERY unlikely to ever play in 5/4 time again so don't worry if it seems complicated - it just happens to be the timing for this particular ballad

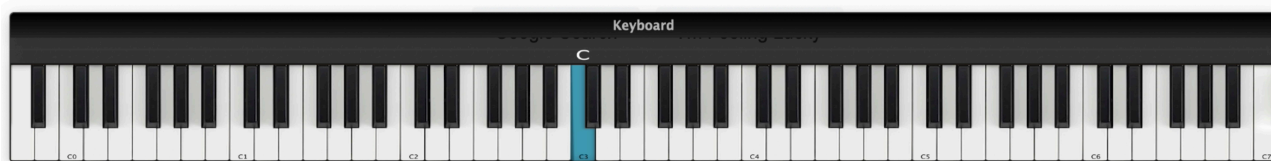
^{*} If you have a 61 keys keyboard - for the B diminished just start at the lowest B note available

Playing the Ballad on smaller keyboards

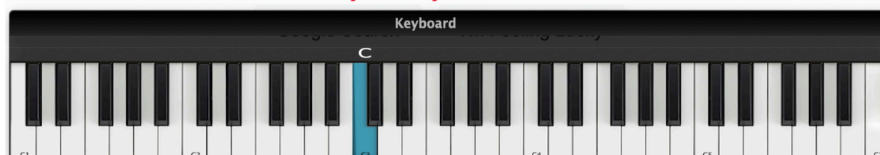
If you have a 61 keys keyboard you will have to adjust the starting point for each pattern. Just choose the lowest starting note available.

Unfortunately if you only have a 49 keys keyboard you won't be able to play the ballad.

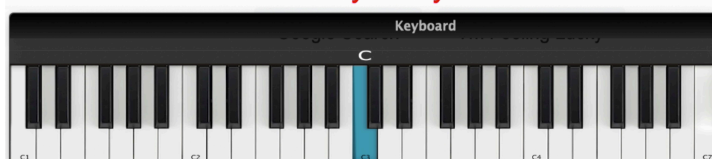
88 Full size piano keys



61 Keys Keyboard



49 Keys Keyboard



Udacity

If you are stuck with a 49 keys keyboard don't worry - the Amazing Broken Chord Ballad is the only exercise in the course that is out of range of your keyboard.

Keep in mind you will find either 49 or 61 keys very limiting for many reasons that you will discover the more piano styles you learn - so I would still recommend that you get a bigger keyboard at some stage.



LESSONS CHECKPOINT



1-76

- ☐ What scale is the C FAMILY CHORDS based on?
- ☐ Can you name and play all the C Family chords? How do you memorize them?
- ☐ Do you understand rhythm number 2 - Straight Beat? Why is it called a 'Straight Beat' rhythm? Do we use the pedal with this rhythm?
- ☐ Do you understand how the practice progressions work?
- ☐ What does one chord in a box indicate? - What do two chords in a box indicate?
- ☐ What are we meant to play when we see a chord name in a box?
- ☐ Have you visited ultimate-guitar.com? Do you understand how to find complete chord progressions with lyrics? Do you understand how to apply what you are learning to the complete song progressions?
- ☐ Did you try all the practice progressions?

The Amazing Broken Chord Ballad

- ☐ How do you play the main pattern for one chord? What is the 'formula'?
- ☐ Can you name the complete chord progression used in the piece?
- ☐ When do you use the pedal in the ballad?
- ☐ How many beats are in each bar for the ballad?

If you feel you understand everything so far you can move on.
But keep practicing the Broken Chord Ballad and any 'Straight Beat' songs you like every day until you can play them with ease

The next rhythm will enable you to play a LOT more songs.

YOU ARE NOW READY
FOR

